

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Mimamsa (Mīmāṃsā) - Learner-v2

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Mimamsa (Mīmāṃsā)

English-first concept spine • Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows in parentheses

- 1 intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)
- 2 postulation (arthāpatti)
- 3 non-cognition (anupalabdhi)
- 4 Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva)
- 5 unseen ritual potency (apūrva)
- 6 indeterminate perception (nirvikalpaka-pratyakṣa)

Read the complete Markdown/PDF for arguments, objections, PYQs and model answers.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Mimamsa (Mīmāṃsā) - Learner-v2 Source-Complete Learning Session

Evidence discipline: Complete legacy teaching and workbook material is preserved, reordered Basic-first/Advanced-last, and checked against the canonical owner and verified 2018-2025 PYQ ledger.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

ENGLISH-FIRST TERMINOLOGY KEY

- self-luminosity (svayaṃprakāśatva)

Mimamsa (Mīmāṃsā)

English-first concept spine • Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows in parentheses

- 1 intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)
- 2 postulation (arthāpatti)
- 3 non-cognition (anupalabdhi)
- 4 Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva)
- 5 unseen ritual potency (apūrva)
- 6 indeterminate perception (nirvikalpa-pratyakṣa)

Read the complete Markdown/PDF for arguments, objections, PYQs and model answers.

Mimamsa (Mīmāṃsā) English-first concept spine

Concept spine: English concepts lead; Sanskrit/Pali IAST follows immediately.

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Syllabus (verbatim): Mimamsa: Theory of Knowledge. **Source order actually used:** canonical owner paper -1/indian/Mimamsa.md; local OCR-searchable Chatterjee-Datta, C.D. Sharma and Radhakrishnan chapters; official contemporary linkage from Central Sanskrit University; Qdrant not required. **Source limitation:** OCR noise in the local philosophy scans was cross-checked against the canonical owner and the verified PYQ ledger. No noisy OCR sentence is reproduced as a quotation. **Evidence key:** FACT: direct source or canonical doctrine • ANALYSIS: analysis, comparison or evaluative synthesis • CAUTION: contested or development-stage claim.

How to use this layered session

Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

Source audit: the canonical Mimamsa knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 Indian Philosophy PYQ bank were checked. The source session's direct OCR anchors to Chatterjee-Datta, C. D. Sharma and Radhakrishnan are retained. The official Central Sanskrit University 2026-27 programme and Sanskrit-promotion context was rechecked and is used only as educational linkage, not as proof of classical doctrine. Qdrant was not required.

Preservation note: every substantive section of the earlier complete session is retained. The new material adds simple visual gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing or compressing the original depth.

SESSION 1 - The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma)

Plain-language visual - from command to delayed result

VEDIC INJUNCTION
|
reveals what ought to be done
|
qualified agent performs the rite
|
UNSEEN RITUAL POTENCY (apūrva) carries efficacy beyond the visible act
|
promised fruit matures later

In simple words: Mimamsa asks how supersensible duty can be known and how a temporary ritual act can produce a later result. Its epistemology and language theory protect this action-guiding role of the Veda.

Term	Easy meaning
Vedic duty (dharma)	Supersensible duty
Injunction (codanā) / prescriptive injunction (vidhi)	Vedic injunction
Impelling force (bhāvanā)	Impelling and productive force
Obligation (niyoga)	Binding to-be-done
Unseen ritual potency (apūrva)	Unseen link between act and fruit

Memory line: Mimamsa is knowledge organised around duty and action.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP

```

MIMAMSA = inquiry into Vedic duty (dharma) through Vedic injunction
|
+--- REALIST BACKGROUND
|   +--- real world, enduring self, karmic continuity
|
+--- EPISTEMIC THESIS
|   +--- intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) = validity intrinsic
|   +--- externally established invalidity (parataḥ-aprāmāṇya) = invalidity
|       discovered later
|
+--- MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇas)
|   +--- Prabhakara: 5
|   +--- Bhatta: 6 (adds anupalabdhi)
|
+--- KEY SPECIALTIES
|   +--- postulation (arthāpatti) = compelled postulation
|   +--- non-cognition (anupalabdhi) = knowledge of absence
|   +--- non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) vs contrary-cognition
|       theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)
|   +--- threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit) vs knownness (jñātātā)
|   +--- abhihitānvaya vs anvītabhidhāna
|
+--- HERMENEUTIC GOAL
|   +--- injunction (codanā) -> duty -> action -> unseen ritual potency (apūrva) -> fruit
|
+--- VEDIC CLAIM
|   +--- Veda is apauruṣeya, eternal, self-valid for Vedic duty (dharma)

```

FACT: The school is not "ritualism plus a few epistemic ideas." Its epistemology, semantics and anti-theistic theology are all designed to secure objective knowledge of Vedic duty (dharma).

1. ORIENTATION, TEXTS, AND THINKERS

FACT: **Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā** is earlier than Uttara-Mīmāṃsā primarily in a **logical** sense: it begins with duty, injunction and ritual action, whereas Vedānta begins with ultimate reality. Chatterjee and Datta explicitly describe Mīmāṃsā as serving ritualism in **two ways** - by offering a method of Vedic interpretation and by supplying a philosophical justification of the faith presupposed by ritual action.

FACT: The intellectual center is **dharma-jijñāsā**. Jaimini's project is not to speculate first about God or Brahman, but to ask how duty is known, how injunction binds, how ritual yields fruit, and why Vedic testimony should be trusted when Vedic duty (dharma) is supersensible.

Thinker / text	Role in the system	What to remember for UPSC
Jaimini - Mīmāṃsā-sūtra	foundational statement of dharma-jijñāsā	codana - laksano'rtho dharmah is the governing formula
Śābara - Śābara-bhāṣya	classical base commentary	later debate takes shape through his exegetical frame
Kumārila Bhaṭṭa	Bhāṭṭa line; stronger realist and polemical style	six means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas), non-cognition (anupalabdhi), knownness (jñātātā), contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)
Prabhākara Miśra	Prābhākara line; greater economy	five means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas), threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit), non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti), anvītabhidhāna
Later manual writers	systematizers and transmitters	Parthasārathi, Śālikanātha and later digests help with technical vocabulary

ANALYSIS: Radhakrishnan and Sharma both show the same broad pattern: **the school shares realism, Vedic authority and intrinsic validity, but splits sharply on absence, error, self-awareness and sentence meaning.** That unity-in-difference is the safest exam posture.

1.1 Why Mimamsa is a major UPSC topic

1. FACT: It gives the strongest Indian defense of **default trust in cognition**.
2. FACT: It refuses to reduce all mediate knowledge to inference, thereby protecting **postulation (arthāpatti)** and, for Bhāṭṭa, **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)**.
3. FACT: It connects epistemology to **language, injunction, ritual efficacy**, and **textual interpretation**.
4. FACT: It offers a strikingly **orthodox yet anti-theistic** model: Veda is secured not by God, but by authorlessness.
5. FACT: Recent UPSC papers repeatedly ask the internal Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara debates, not generic summary alone.

1.2 Minimal metaphysical background

- FACT: The world is real, not a mere appearance or projection.
- FACT: The self is enduring enough to be knower, doer and enjoyer.
- FACT: Action and moral consequence (karma) must connect an act and its later fruit.
- FACT: Vedic duty (dharma) is supersensible and therefore unavailable to mere perception.
- FACT: Hence epistemology, semantics and ritual hermeneutics are structurally connected.

2. VISUAL - KNOWLEDGE IN DEFENCE OF VEDIC DUTY (dharma)

The visual keeps the whole optional route in view: epistemology protects Vedic authority, Vedic authority grounds duty, duty becomes action through injunction, and action yields fruit through unseen ritual potency (apūrva) without needing a creator-God.

3. VEDIC DUTY (dharma), INJUNCTION (codanā), PRESCRIPTIVE INJUNCTION (vidhi), UNSEEN RITUAL POTENCY (apūrva), IMPELLING FORCE (bhāvanā), OBLIGATION (niyoga)

FACT: **Jaimini's formula:** codana - laksano 'r tho dharmah - Vedic duty (dharma) is that end or object characterized by Vedic injunction.

3.1 Vedic duty (dharma) is known as what ought to be done

FACT: Mīmāṃsā does not define Vedic duty (dharma) as bare moral feeling. It defines Vedic duty (dharma) as what the Veda **enjoins**. Therefore its central sentence-type is **prescriptive injunction (vidhi)** (injunction), complemented by **niṣedha** (prohibition).

Term	Meaning	Why it matters
Vedic duty (dharma)	supersensible duty known through Vedic injunction	gives the entire school its objective
Injunction (codanā) / prescriptive injunction (vidhi)	impelling Vedic command	makes the sentence action-guiding rather than merely descriptive
Niṣedha	prohibition	marks what ought not to be done
Unseen ritual potency (apūrva)	unseen potency generated by correct ritual action	links a perishing act to a delayed fruit
Śābdī impelling force (bhāvanā)	linguistic impelling force of the injunction	explains how the word motivates action
Ārthī impelling force (bhāvanā)	real productive force of the agent's performance	explains how action leads to result
Obligation (niyoga)	the binding "to-be-done"	central to Prābhākara duty theory

3.2 From Vedic sentence to ritual fruit

Vedic injunction heard
 ->
 qualified agent understands duty
 ->
 linguistic force (sabdi bhavana) produces undertaking
 ->
 ritual act is performed with proper accessories
 ->
 real productive force (arthi bhavana) operates
 ->
 unseen ritual potency (apūrva) persists after the visible act ends
 ->
 promised fruit matures later

3.3 Bhāṭṭa versus Prābhākara on obligation

Issue	Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā
Immediate theory	Bhāvanā-vāda	Niyoga-vāda
What binds?	injunction impels action toward a desired result	injunction directly presents the act as to-be-done
Motivation	qualified desire, especially for phala such as heaven	categorical obligation for the adhikārin
Standard contrast	closer to result-oriented ritual psychology	closer to deontological duty

ANALYSIS: A controlled comparison with Kant is permissible only as a **last-line analogy**. Prābhākara duty is not grounded in autonomous rational law, but in the impersonal authority of the Veda.

3.4 Aṃśa-traya - the three questions every injunction must answer

FACT: Mīmāṃsā analyzes injunction through three factors:

1. **bhāvya / sādhya** - what is to be brought about;
2. **karāṇa / sādhana** - by what means;
3. **itikartavyatā** - how exactly it is to be done.

In svargakamo yajeta, heaven is the end, sacrifice is the means, and the whole ritual procedure gives the "how".

3.5 Vedānta objection and Mīmāṃsā reply

- WRONG: **Objection:** Upaniṣadic statements such as tat tvam asi reveal an already accomplished reality and cannot be reduced to injunction.
- FACT: **Mīmāṃsā reply:** Vedic purposiveness becomes unintelligible if scriptural meaning is detached from action. Therefore even non-injunctive passages are interpreted through their relation to ritual or contemplative practice.
- ANALYSIS: **Residual pressure:** this is exactly where Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā and Vedānta part company most sharply.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma)
 ->
 0. ONE-SCREEN MAP
 ->
 1. ORIENTATION, TEXTS, AND THINKERS
 ->
 1.1 Why Mimamsa is a major UPSC topic
 ->
 UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 2 - Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture

Plain-language visual - trust first, revise when defeated

```

COGNITION ARISES
|
prima facie authority
|
act on it normally
|
later contradiction or defect?
  no -> remains valid
  yes -> invalidity discovered externally
  
```

In simple words: Mimamsa says knowledge does not wait for a second certificate before it can guide action. Cognition is trusted by default; error is established later through defeat.

School	Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)
Prabhakara	5
Bhatta	6, adding non-cognition (anupalabधि)
Nyaya	4

Memory line: intrinsic validity is defeasible default trust, not infallibility.

4. VALIDITY AND MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa) ARCHITECTURE

4.1 Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) and externally established invalidity (parataḥ-aprāmāṇya)

FACT: Mīmāṃsā holds that cognition is **prima facie valid by its own occurrence** under normal conditions. One does not wait for a second certificate before acting. Falsity, by contrast, is detected **later** through contradiction, defect or practical defeat.

Aspect	Mimamsa claim	Meaning
Origin of validity	intrinsic	the same conditions that produce cognition produce its authority
Awareness of validity	intrinsic	cognition presents itself as trustworthy without needing prior verification
Origin of invalidity	extrinsic	falsity arises from defect, mislocation, or counterevidence
Awareness of invalidity	extrinsic	later correction, contradiction or discovery of defect reveals it

MEMORY: Exam formula: default validity is **not** infallibility. The doctrine says “trust first, revise when defeated,” not “whatever appears is eternally true.”

4.2 Why Mimamsa defends intrinsic validity

1. FACT: Otherwise every cognition would need another cognition to validate it.
2. FACT: The validator would itself need validation.
3. FACT: Infinite regress would follow.
4. FACT: Practical life would never begin.
5. FACT: Therefore default epistemic trust is built into cognition itself.

Chatterjee and Datta summarize the doctrine in a memorable way: **belief is normal; disbelief is exceptional.**

4.3 Nyāya contrast - external validation (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)

FACT: Naiyāyikas stress successful activity, correspondence and later reflective certification. Mimamsa objects that such external validation already presupposes trust in the cognition on which one acts.

Issue	Mimamsa	Nyāya
starting status of cognition	trusted unless defeated	validated by something outside the first cognition
standard concern	anti-regress and default authority	verification, successful action, reflective certainty
major risk	critics charge gullibility	critics charge regress or hidden prior trust

4.4 The means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) map

School	Accepted means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)
Sāṃkhya	perception, inference, testimony
Nyāya	perception, inference, comparison, testimony
Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	perception, inference, comparison, testimony, postulation (arthāpatti)
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	perception, inference, comparison, testimony, postulation (arthāpatti), non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

4.5 Why memory is not a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)

FACT: Both Prābhākara and Nyāya reject memory as a source of valid knowledge because it does **not** disclose a previously unknown object. It re-presents old content, and its dependence on prior cognition is exactly why it lacks pramāṇa-status.

Fresh cognition	Memory
reveals what is not yet known as presently cognized	depends on an earlier cognition and a residual impression
can count as valid cognition (pramā)	can be true, but is not a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)
basis of present disclosure	basis of re-presentation

4.6 Two master warnings

1. ANALYSIS: **Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)** is a thesis about **validity**, not automatically about **self-awareness**.
2. ANALYSIS: **Self-luminosity** and **intrinsic validity** often travel together, but the Bhāṭṭa position proves they are conceptually distinct.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture

->

4. VALIDITY AND MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa) ARCHITECTURE

->

4.1 Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) and externally established invalidity (parataḥ-aprāmāṇya)

->

4.2 Why Mimamsa defends intrinsic validity

->

UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 3 - Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence

Plain-language visual - two special knowledge situations

DEVADATTA IS STOUT
+ DOES NOT EAT BY DAY

|
facts cannot stand together unaided

|
POSTULATE NIGHT EATING = POSTULATION (arthāpatti)

WELL-LIT EMPTY TABLE
+ JAR WOULD BE SEEN IF PRESENT

|
JAR IS ABSENT = NON-COGNITION (anupalabdhi)

In simple words: postulation (arthāpatti) supplies the fact required to make accepted data coherent. Non-cognition (anupalabdhi) knows absence when all conditions for seeing a present object are satisfied.

Memory line: explanatory compulsion is not mere guess; meaningful non-perception is not mere ignorance.

5. POSTULATION (arthāpatti) AND NON-COGNITION (anupalabdhi)

5.1 Postulation (arthāpatti) - compelled explanatory postulation

FACT: Postulation (arthāpatti) is not a guess and not a loose “best explanation.” It is the **necessary postulation** of an unseen fact without which accepted facts would remain incompatible.

5.2 The Devadatta model

Known fact 1: Devadatta is stout.

Known fact 2: Devadatta does not eat during the day.

Tension: stoutness and total non-nourishment cannot stand together.

Postulate: Devadatta must eat at night.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta distinguish **dr̥ṣṭārthāpatti** (used to explain what is observed) and **śrutārthāpatti** (used to explain what is heard). UPSC usually expects the **stout Devadatta** example first.

5.3 Why Nyāya reduction to inference is resisted

Nyāya reduction attempt	Mimamsa reply
convert the case into a universal: “all stout day-fasters eat at night”	the alleged universal is not independently known; it is extracted from the very postulational situation
treat stoutness as hetu and night-eating as sādhyā	the cognitive movement is from incompatibility to explanatory supplementation, not from sign to signified
call it a disguised inference	it lacks the standard pakṣa-hetu-sādhyā structure and depends on explanatory necessity

ANALYSIS: The safest verdict is: **postulation (arthāpatti) is the epistemology of explanatory compulsion.**

5.4 The 2024 candidate-success application

FACT: If a candidate is never seen studying during the day and still tops an exam, a Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsaka postulates unseen preparation - probably night study or another unobserved time-slot. A Naiyāyika tries to reconstruct the case as inference from a rule connecting success and preparation. The question tests whether you can preserve that difference.

5.5 Non-cognition (anupalabdhi) - knowledge of absence

FACT: **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā** alone among the two sub-schools grants **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** independent pramāṇa-status. It is knowledge of absence through **non-apprehension of what would be apprehended if present.**

5.6 Eligible non-cognition (yogyānupalabdhi) - the limiting condition

For valid absence-cognition, the following must be in place:

1. **FACT:** the object must be perceptible in principle;

2. FACT: the locus must be properly available;
3. FACT: the relevant sense-organ must be functioning;
4. FACT: lighting, distance and attention must be appropriate.

Only then does non-perception justify the judgment “the book is not on the table.” One cannot move from failure to see atoms to the conclusion that there are no atoms, because atoms are not perceptible objects of that kind.

5.7 Nature of absence (abhāva) and its knowledge

View	What is absent?	How known?
Bhāṭṭa	absence (abhāva) is real and structured by a counterpositive	known through non-cognition (anupalabdhi)
Prābhākara	what is directly given is the bare locus unqualified by the missing object	no separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) needed
Nyāya	absence is a real category	often treated as perceptible or inferable, not requiring a separate non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

ANALYSIS: The Bhāṭṭa view pays an ontological cost - reality contains structured negatives - but it preserves the determinacy of everyday negative cognition.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence

->

5. POSTULATION (arthāpatti) AND NON-COGNITION (anupalabdhi)

->

5.1 Postulation (arthāpatti) - compelled explanatory postulation

->

5.2 The Devadatta model

->

UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 4 - Self-Awareness and Error: Tripuṭi, Knownness (jñātātā) and Two Mimamsa Theories

Plain-language visual - how is knowing itself known?

PRABHAKARA: knower + object + cognition appear together

BHATTA: object's being-known points to the cognition

NYAYA: later reflection says "I know the object"

ILLUSION:

Prabhakara -> perception and memory not discriminated

Bhatta -> positive false synthesis under defect

In simple words: the two Mimamsa schools agree that cognition is trusted by default but disagree about how cognition becomes known and how illusion occurs.

Memory line: shared validity theory does not erase different accounts of awareness and error.

6. SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR

6.1 How do I know that I know?

School	How cognition is known	Core term
Prābhākara	cognition reveals knower, known and itself together	threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit)
Bhāṭṭa	cognition is inferred from the cognizedness of the object	knownness (jñātātā)
Nyāya	a second-order reflective awareness takes the first cognition as its object	anuvyavasāya

6.2 Threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit)

FACT: In every cognition, Prābhākara says the triad is simultaneously given:

- **jñātr** - the knower,
- **jñeya** - the known object,
- **knowledge (jñāna)** - the cognition itself.

This blocks regress: if cognition were not manifest in the very act of knowing, another cognition would be needed to reveal it.

6.3 Knownness (jñātātā)

FACT: Kumārila denies that cognition is self-luminous. What is directly secured is the object's state of **being-known**. From that cognizedness, a cognition is inferred.

ANALYSIS: This is the exact Bhāṭṭa proof that **intrinsic validity** does not logically require **self-luminosity**.

6.4 Error theory - non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) versus contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)

Issue	Prābhākara	Bhāṭṭa
Basic claim	no single false cognition is required	a genuinely false cognition occurs under defective conditions
Standard model	shell is perceived; silver is remembered; difference is not discriminated	shell is positively misapprehended as silver
Name	non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) / vivekākhyāti	contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)
Why it matters	protects truth of each constituent cognition	explains the assertive force of illusion more naturally

6.5 Cross-school comparison

School	Theory of error	Central idea
Prābhākara	non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti)	non-discrimination between valid perception and valid memory
Bhāṭṭa	contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)	positive misapprehension caused by defect
Nyāya	anyathā-khyāti	a real object known elsewhere is misrelated here
Advaita	anirvacanīya-khyāti	the illusory object is neither fully real nor unreal

ANALYSIS: The 2022 twenty-marker turns on the paradox: **both sub-schools keep intrinsic validity, yet one minimizes falsity while the other allows error under extrinsic defect.**

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

Self-Awareness and Error: Tripuṭi, Knownness (jñātātā) and Two Mimamsa Theories

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6. SELF-AWARENESS AND ERROR

->

6.1 How do I know that I know?

->

6.2 Threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit)

->

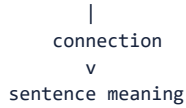
UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 5 - Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics

Plain-language visual - two routes from words to a sentence

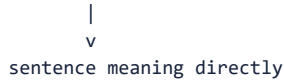
BHATTA:

word 1 meaning + word 2 meaning + word 3 meaning



PRABHAKARA:

each word already conveys meaning-in-relation



In simple words: Bhatta begins with stable lexical units and then composes them. Prabhakara begins with connected practical language-use.

Sentence condition	Meaning
Akanksa	Mutual expectancy
Yogyata	Semantic fitness
Sannidhi	Proper proximity

Memory line: one theory composes meanings; the other receives them already connected.

7. VERBAL TESTIMONY (śabda), WORD-MEANING, SENTENCE-MEANING, AND RITUAL HERMENEUTICS

7.1 Why language matters so much

FACT: Mīmāṃsā is a school of **textual action-guidance**. It therefore asks not merely what words mean, but how a string of words becomes a binding unit of duty. The great question is **ekavākyatā** - sentence-unity.

7.2 Shared conditions of sentence unity

Condition	Meaning	Failure case
ākāṅkṣā	mutual expectancy among words	a verb with no completing object or subject
yogyatā	semantic fitness	impossible combination like “sprinkle with fire” in ordinary usage
sannidhi / āsatti	proper proximity or contiguity	words too far apart to belong to one sentence

ANALYSIS: Naiyāyikas often add **tātparya** as speaker's intention. Mīmāṃsā cannot ground the Veda in the psychology of a speaker, because the Veda is **apauruṣeya**.

7.3 Designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda) versus connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhānavāda)

Question	Bhāṭṭa answer	Prābhākara answer
What do words first convey?	isolated word-meanings	connected meanings already in relation
Sentence meaning arises how?	by connecting what words have already denoted	directly through words as context-bound conveyors
Usual label	designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda)	connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhānavāda)
Pedagogic intuition	lexical units first, then composition	practical sentence-use first, isolated meaning is derivative

FACT: Bhāṭṭa secures stable lexical meaning. FACT: Prābhākara secures contextual and action-guiding meaning. UPSC rewards answers that state both gains and both costs.

7.4 Do words refer to universals or particulars?

FACT: Mīmāṃsā generally gives semantic priority to **jāti** (universal), whereas Nyāya gives priority to the **qualified individual**. The dispute is not whether words can reach individuals at all, but **what explains repeatable meaning**.

Position	Why it chooses that priority
Mīmāṃsā	the same word applies across many individuals; universality explains repeatability
Nyāya	actual action concerns qualified individuals; universals function within that concrete referent

7.5 Ritual hermeneutics

FACT: Mīmāṃsā is also a theory of interpretation. The school develops ranked interpretive clues so that Vedic texts can be harmonized without collapse into arbitrariness.

Hermeneutic cue	Use
śruti	explicit statement
liṅga	indicative mark or clue
vākya	sentence-unity
prakaraṇa	larger context or topic
sthāna	placement
samākhyā	title or heading-name
utsarga / apavāda	general rule and exception

ANALYSIS: These are not decorative scholastic devices. They are the technical engine by which ritual duty is extracted from a large authorless corpus.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics

->

7. VERBAL TESTIMONY (śabda), WORD-MEANING, SENTENCE-MEANING, AND RITUAL HERMENEUTICS

->

7.1 Why language matters so much

->

7.2 Shared conditions of sentence unity

->

UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 6 - Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa)

Plain-language visual - authority by removing the author

PERSONAL AUTHOR

can be ignorant, deceptive or partial

|

MIMAMSA EXCLUDES AUTHORSHIP

|

eternal word-meaning relation + unique access to Vedic duty (dharma)

|

VEDIC AUTHORITY

ritual action -> unseen ritual potency (apūrva) -> fruit

No creator or fruit-dispenser God required.

In simple words: Nyaya protects scripture through a perfect author. Mimamsa protects it by denying that it has an author at all.

Memory line: exclude the source of authorial defect rather than perfect the author.

8. VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (apauruṣeyatva), VEDIC AUTHORITY, SELF, WORLD, GOD, ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma), LIBERATION (mokṣa)

8.1 Why Vedic authority matters

FACT: Perception shows visible things. Inference extends from marks to unobserved correlates. But **Vedic duty (dharma)** is neither visibly given nor inferable from ordinary worldly signs. Therefore **verbal testimony (śabda)**, especially Vedic verbal testimony (śabda), becomes indispensable.

8.2 Vedic authorlessnessness (apauruṣeyatva) and eternity of word (śabda-nityatva)

FACT: Mīmāṃsā defends the Veda as **authorless** and, in the relevant sense, **eternal**.

Main argumentative moves:

1. FACT: there is no remembered historical author of the Veda;
2. FACT: authorship would import the possibility of ignorance, deception or partiality;
3. FACT: word-meaning relation is treated as **autpattika** - natural or inherent, not newly set up by convention;
4. FACT: utterance manifests words rather than creating them anew;
5. FACT: therefore Vedic authority need not rest on a divine or human speaker.

Radhakrishnan's summary is especially useful: Mīmāṃsā protests against treating the Vedas as the work of God because a bodiless God has no organs of speech, and divine authorship would make Vedic authority depend on proving a person.

8.3 Why Nyāya and Mimamsa diverge over scripture

Issue	Mīmāṃsā	Nyāya
source of scriptural authority	authorless eternal Veda	omniscient reliable author (āpta), ultimately Lord (Īśvara)
word-meaning relation	natural / inherent	conventional, instituted
preferred strategy	protect text by excluding author	protect text by perfecting author
Mimamsa objection	proving God's omniscience is harder than accepting authorlessness	authorlessness seems historically implausible

8.4 Self, world and action and moral consequence (karma)

- FACT: The world is real.
- FACT: The self is enduring, not momentary.
- FACT: The self must persist as **knower, agent and enjoyer**; otherwise the performer of ritual could not be the receiver of its fruit.
- FACT: Action and moral consequence (karma) requires continuity between deed and consequence.
- FACT: Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) is the unseen link between a perishing act and a delayed fruit.

8.5 God and anti-theism

FACT: Classical Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā rejects a **creator-God** and a **fruit-dispenser God**. This is not heterodoxy in the ordinary āstika sense, because orthodoxy here means fidelity to the Veda, not devotion to a creator.

Main anti-theistic reasons:

1. FACT: Veda does not need a divine author if it is apauruṣeya.
2. FACT: God would become a redundant extra alongside action and moral consequence (karma) and unseen ritual potency (apūrva).
3. FACT: If God dispenses according to action and moral consequence (karma), action and moral consequence (karma) does the real work.
4. FACT: If God dispenses independently of action and moral consequence (karma), divine partiality appears.

5. FACT: The potter-world analogy proves too little: we observe pots made by embodied artisans, not worlds made by bodiless creators.

ANALYSIS: **Qualification:** ritual deities are not simply erased. They remain mantra-denoted entities inside sacrificial procedure, but they are not the sovereign producers of fruits.

8.6 Liberation (mokṣa) in Mimamsa

CAUTION: Early Mīmāṃsā is more **svarga-oriented** than liberation-oriented. Later presentations, however, clearly describe liberation (mokṣa) as cessation of pain, embodiment and karmic entanglement.

FACT: Sharma is explicit that later Mīmāṃsakas treat liberation (mokṣa) negatively - as release from bondage and suffering rather than as Advaitic identity with Brahman. That caution is important: **do not Vedāntize Mīmāṃsā liberation (mokṣa).**

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa)

->

8. VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (apauruṣeyatva), VEDIC AUTHORITY, SELF, WORLD, GOD, ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma), LIBERATION (mokṣa)

->

8.1 Why Vedic authority matters

->

8.2 Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva) and eternity of word (śabda-nityatva)

->

UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 7 - Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context

Plain-language visual - the main pressure points

NYAYA -> validity and special means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) can be reduced externally

ADVAITA -> Veda also reveals accomplished reality, not only action

BUDDHISM -> eternal words, universals and enduring self are excessive

MIMAMSA -> default trust + textual rules + unseen ritual potency (apūrva) preserve duty

In simple words: Mimamsa gains a powerful impersonal theory of normativity, but pays for it through eternal language, special means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas), structured absences and unseen ritual potency.

Memory line: its achievement is normativity without divine command; its cost is a demanding hermeneutic ontology.

9. MASTER COMPARISON GRID, CRITICISMS, AND UPSC TRAPS

9.1 Master comparison grid

Issue	Mīmāṃsā	Nyāya	Advaita Vedānta
validity	intrinsic	extrinsic / certification-heavy	knowledge valid until sublated within layered reality
special means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)	postulation (arthāpatti); Bhāṭṭa adds non-cognition (anupalabdhi)	reduces them where possible	often accepts six means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) in later Advaita
cognition of cognition	threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit) or knownness (jñātātā)	anuvyavasāya	self-luminous consciousness
Veda	authorless and eternal	reliable because of Lord (Īśvara)	Upaniṣads reveal siddha-vastu
God	no creator or fruit-dispenser needed	theistic realism	empirical Lord (Īśvara), ultimate non-dual Brahman
liberation (mokṣa)	later negative release from suffering and embodiment	release from pain	knowledge of identity of enduring self (ātman) and Brahman

9.2 Strong objections and the best Mimamsa replies

Objection	Best Mimamsa reply	Residual pressure
intrinsic validity licenses gullibility	default validity is defeasible and falsity is discovered later	critics ask whether this postpones rather than solves the problem
postulation (arthāpatti) is hidden inference	explanatory compulsion is not the same as sign-based inference	Nyāya can still simulate many cases inferentially
non-cognition (anupalabdhi) reifies negatives	determinate absence-cognition needs an object and a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	ontological economy is sacrificed
sentence meaning needs a speaker's intention	Vedic purport is textual and rule-governed, not psychological	meaning without intending subject remains contested
authorless eternal language is implausible	authorlessness removes the whole class of authorial defects	conventionalist and Buddhist criticisms remain serious
action and moral consequence (karma) needs an intelligent administrator	unseen ritual potency (apūrva) and beginningless order suffice	many still find unconscious potency obscure

9.3 High-value UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Prābhākara has five means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas), not six.**
2. ANALYSIS: **Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) is not infallibilism.**
3. ANALYSIS: **Bhāṭṭa can deny self-luminosity and still defend intrinsic validity.**
4. ANALYSIS: **Non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) means non-discrimination, not total absence of cognition.**
5. ANALYSIS: **Non-cognition (anupalabdhi) is a Bhāṭṭa specialty.**
6. ANALYSIS: **Abhihitānvaya and anvītābhīdhāna are not the same debate as universal versus individual reference, though they interact.**
7. ANALYSIS: **Mīmāṃsā does not prove Veda through God; it secures Veda by excluding God as author.**
8. ANALYSIS: **Liberation (mokṣa) in Mīmāṃsā is not merger into Brahman.**
9. ANALYSIS: **Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) is the link between act and fruit; it is not identical with God, fate or visible physical causation.**
10. ANALYSIS: **Bhāvanā-vāda and niyoga-vāda must be kept distinct.**

10. CONTEMPORARY LINKAGE - CENTRAL SANSKRIT UNIVERSITY, 2026-27

FACT: Verified official anchor: the Central Sanskrit University page for **Central Schemes - Online Application Forms** states that online applications are invited for financial assistance for the year **2026-27** under “**Schemes for Sanskrit Promotion.**” The page lists Sanskrit teaching support, programmes and activities, publication and reprint of Sanskrit books, Shashtra Chudamani, scholarships in Sanskrit/Pali/Prakrit, vocational courses, and Ashtaadashi projects. The same official CSU portal was identified by web search as carrying the formal English notification dated **01/04/2026.**

ANALYSIS: Why this is a legitimate Mimamsa linkage: it does **not** prove Mīmāṃsā doctrine and should never be presented as evidence for Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva), intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) or ritual efficacy. It is relevant only because Mīmāṃsā lives in a world of Sanskrit textual transmission, publication, teaching, commentary, and interpretive training. A modern state-supported Sanskrit ecosystem keeps alive the language-and-text conditions within which Vedic hermeneutics remains publicly meaningful.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context

->

9. MASTER COMPARISON GRID, CRITICISMS, AND UPSC TRAPS

->

9.1 Master comparison grid

->

9.2 Strong objections and the best Mimamsa replies

->

UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 8 - PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

Plain-language visual - route the question before writing

QUESTION

|

+++ validity / memory

+++ postulation (arthāpatti) / non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

+++ self-awareness / error

+++ word and sentence meaning

+++ Vedic authority / God

|

technical distinction -> example -> rival -> verdict

In simple words: the 14 verified questions repeatedly test internal Bhatta-Prabhakara differences and contrasts with Nyaya or Advaita. Precision in sub-school attribution is essential.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Definition -> example -> contrast -> verdict
15	Problem -> mechanism -> objection/reply -> assessment
20	Full distinction -> both sub-schools -> rival comparison -> judgement

Memory line: attribute first, compare second, evaluate third.

11. PYQ ROUTING (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: 14 primary-owned question-parts out of 112 in the verified Indian Philosophy bank. Mimamsa appears in every year from 2018 through 2025.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q8(a)	20 marks	Does the admission of Svayamprakāśavāda necessarily lead to the admission of Svataḥprāmāṇyavāda? Discuss after the Naiyāyikas, the Mīmāṃsakas and the Advaita Vedāntins.
2019	Q5(e)	10 marks	How does Mīmāṃsā establish the authority of Vedic knowledge?
2020	Q5(c)	10 marks	Why is memory not a valid knowledge according to Mīmāṃsā?
2021	Q6(c)	15 marks	What, according to Mīmāṃsakas, is the ontological status of absence (abhāva) and how does one know it? Explain and examine.
2022	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do Mīmāṃsakas refute the Nyāya view that Implication (arthāpatti) is reducible to Inference (anumāna) and establish Implication as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)? Critically discuss.
2022	Q7(a)	20 marks	In spite of accepting the intrinsic validity of knowledge, why and how Prabhākara and Kumārila differ in their interpretation of erroneous cognition? Discuss.
2023	Q6(b)	15 marks	Present Bhaṭṭa's view of non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as a valid means of knowledge.
2023	Q8(c)	15 marks	Do words refer to universals or particulars or both? Present an exposition of Nyāya and Mīmāṃsā position with regard to above question along with suitable examples.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2024	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Bhaṭṭa's view of nature of word-meaning and sentential-meaning differ from Prabhākara's view? Critically discuss.
2024	Q8(a)	20 marks	How do I know that I know? Answer this question with reference to the Naiyāyikas, the Bhaṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Prābhākaras.
2024	Q8(b)	15 marks	"A candidate who is never seen to be studying during the day time secures a high position in a competitive exam." How would the Bhaṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Naiyāyikas explain the success of this candidate? Discuss.
2024	Q8(c)	15 marks	On what grounds do the Prābhākaras and the Naiyāyikas reject memory as a source of knowledge? Discuss.
2025	Q5(c)	10 marks	Delineate the main points of difference between the theory of intrinsic validation (svataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) and theory of extrinsic validation (parataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) in classical Indian philosophy.
2025	Q6(c)	15 marks	Discuss the debate between the Bhaṭṭa and the Prabhākara mīmāṃsakas with reference to the nature of Non-existence (Abhāva) and its knowledge.

12. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

12.1 Ten-marker (10 marks)

Define the doctrine exactly.
 State the standard example.
 Give the sub-school or rival-school contrast.
 Add one criticism or limitation.
 Close with one direct evaluative line.

12.2 Fifteen-marker (15 marks)

Frame the problem.
 Explain the mechanism in ordered steps.
 Use one example and one comparison.
 Add one objection and one reply.
 Conclude with a reasoned verdict.

12.3 Twenty-marker (20 marks)

Open with the conceptual issue, not only a definition.
 Reconstruct the doctrine in full.
 Bring in both Bhaṭṭa and Prābhākara where relevant.
 Compare with Nyāya and/or Advaita.
 State the deepest criticism and the best Mīmāṃsā reply.
 End with a graded judgement.

13. SOURCES AND LOCAL EVIDENCE

- FACT: Canonical owner read end-to-end:
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Philosophy\paper-1\indian\Mimamsa.md.
- FACT: Verified question wording and routing controlled by:
upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Philosophy\paper-1_PYQ-Indian-Philosophy-2018-2025.md.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta, **Chapter IX - The Mimamsa Philosophy**, local OCR-searchable PDF
books\philosophy_books\Chatterjeedatta_introductionToIndianPhilosophy.pdf, especially file
pages **379-409** for the two-fold role of Mīmāṃsā, the list of means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas), postulation
(arthāpatti), Vedic authorlessness and the non-creator stance.
- FACT: C.D. Sharma, **Purva-Mimamsa** discussion in
books\philosophy_books\Indian-Philosophy-A-Critical-Survey.pdf, especially searchable file
pages around **203** and **233-236** for postulation (arthāpatti), knownness (jñātātā), later liberation (mokṣa) doctrine
and Kumārila's historical role.
- FACT: Radhakrishnan, **The Purva Mimamsa** chapter in books\philosophy_books\Indian Philosophy
Vol. 2 by Radhakrishnan.pdf, especially file pages **383-414** for means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas),
threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit), knownness (jñātātā), Veda, and anti-theistic argument.

- FACT: Official contemporary linkage verified through https://sanskrit.nic.in/schemes/central_schemes_forms.php and the associated CSU notification identified by web search on the same official portal.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

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11. PYQ ROUTING (2018-2025)

->

12. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

->

12.1 Ten-marker (10 marks)

->

UPSC distinction and qualified verdict

SESSION 9 - REVIEW-PROMOTED KNOWLEDGE-SOURCE AND HERMENEUTIC COMPLETENESS

This session repairs the taxonomy that a “theory of knowledge” answer presupposes but the shorter syllabus heading does not enumerate. It keeps Mīmāṃsā’s ownership distinct from Nyāya and Vedānta.

14. TEXTUAL LINEAGE AND OWNER BOUNDARIES

Thinker / text	Secure orientation	Do not flatten
Jaimini - Mīmāṃsā Sūtra	inquiry into duty and Vedic interpretation	not a Vedānta treatise on Brahman
Śabara - Śābara Bhāṣya	foundational surviving commentary	not one of the later rival sub-schools
Kumārila Bhaṭṭa	Bhāṭṭa epistemology, language and polemic	six means of valid knowledge, including non-cognition
Prabhākara Miśra	Prābhākara epistemology and sentence theory	five means of valid knowledge and threefold awareness

FACT: Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā owns injunction, duty, authorless verbal authority and ritual interpretation. Uttara-Mīmāṃsā or Vedānta owns the Brahman-centred interpretation of the Upaniṣads.

15. MEANS, TRUE COGNITION AND PRACTICAL SUCCESS

- A means of valid knowledge (**pramāṇa**) generates a fresh true cognition.
- The resulting **true cognition (pramā / pramiti)** guides action toward its object.
- **Successful action (pravṛtti-sāmarthya)** can confirm correspondence, but Mīmāṃsā denies that later success creates validity after the first cognition.
- Prābhākara manifests subject, object and cognition together; Bhāṭṭa infers cognition through the object’s acquired knownness.

16. PERCEPTION, COMPARISON AND TESTIMONY

Source	Marks-essential account	Rival-control
Indeterminate perception (nirvikalpaka-pratyakṣa)	first non-verbal object-awareness before explicit classification	not sheer non-being or error
Determinate perception (savikalpaka-pratyakṣa)	object as qualified by class, quality, action and name	develops what was implicitly available
Comparison (upamāna)	from a present gavaya's similarity to a remembered cow, know the absent cow as similar to this gavaya	Nyāya instead uses prior testimony to learn the word-object relation
Personal testimony (pauruṣeya-śabda)	depends on a competent speaker and can inherit speaker-defect	ordinary testimony
Impersonal testimony (apauruṣeya-śabda)	Vedic testimony in the supersensible domain of duty	does not depend on a divine author

ANALYSIS: The comparison case must not be written in Nyāya form. For Mīmāṃsā, the new cognition concerns the similarity of the previously known but presently absent cow to the perceived gavaya.

17. TWO ROUTES OF POSTULATION

- **Perceptual postulation (dṛṣṭārthāpatti)**: perceived facts require an unseen reconciler-stout Devadatta who does not eat by day must eat at night.
- **Verbal postulation (śrutarthāpatti)**: heard words require supplementation to yield a coherent sentence-meaning.
- Both express explanatory necessity; neither is a tentative guess.

18. VEDIC SENTENCE AND INJUNCTION TAXONOMY

Function	English-first role
Injunction (vidhi)	enjoins a duty or ritual act
Prohibition (niṣedha)	forbids an act
Mantra (mantra)	recalls deity, material or ritual detail during performance
Name (nāmadheya)	identifies a rite or ritual component
Explanatory or praise passage (arthavāda)	praises, blames, narrates or explains in support of action-guiding text

- **Novel injunction (apūrva-vidhi)** reveals an otherwise unknown duty.
- **Restrictive injunction (niyama-vidhi)** selects one eligible means where alternatives appear available.
- **Exclusionary injunction (parisaṃkhyā-vidhi)** excludes alternatives.
- The separate act/application/order/agent grid-**utpatti**, **viniyoga**, **prayoga**, **adhikāra**-coordinates a complex rite and must not be confused with the preceding threefold classification.

19. UNIVERSALS, SELF AND LIBERATION BOUNDARIES

- Mīmāṃsā grounds repeatable word-use in a real universal. Against Buddhist **meaning through exclusion (apoha)**, it argues that stable positive recognition cannot be explained by exclusion alone.
- It accepts many enduring selves as knowers, agents and enjoyers; cognition is episodic rather than the self's uninterrupted manifest essence.
- Later liberation requires ending fresh merit and demerit and exhausting prior karmic force, so no new embodiment or painful experience arises.
- Cārvāka challenges authorless Veda, unseen potency and non-perceptual sources; this objection should be answered without pretending that a defence of non-perceptual knowledge automatically proves every ritual claim.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - KNOWLEDGE-SOURCE AND HERMENEUTIC COMPLETENESS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS lineage · two perception stages · Mīmāṃsā comparison · two testimony	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT intrinsic validity -> differentiated sources -> authorless sentence ->	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Nyāya differs on comparison, validation and scripture; Buddhism differs	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not import the Nyāya gavaya account, conflate injunction taxonomies,
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā is a realist epistemology whose differentiated			

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

RAPID REVISION 1 - The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma)

Rapid recall

- Jaimini: *Mīmamsa-sutra*; Sabara: foundational commentary.
- Kumarila: Bhatta; Prabhakara: Prabhakara school.
- Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction.
- Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) explains delayed ritual efficacy without God.
- Trap: Mimamsa's primary project is not proof of Brahman or creator God.

RAPID REVISION 2 - Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture

Rapid recall

- Belief is normal; disbelief is exceptional.
- Intrinsic validity does not mean permanent truth.
- Prabhakara has five means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas); Bhatta has six.
- Memory re-presents prior content.
- Trap: validity theory is not automatically a theory of self-awareness.

RAPID REVISION 3 - Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence

Rapid recall

- Postulation (arthāpatti) = compelled explanatory postulation.
- Devadatta is the standard example.
- Bhatta alone accepts non-cognition (anupalabdhi) independently.
- Yogyata makes non-perception evidential.
- Trap: not seeing an imperceptible entity does not establish its absence.

RAPID REVISION 4 - Self-Awareness and Error: Triputi, Knownness (jñātatā) and Two Mimamsa Theories

Rapid recall

- Prabhakara: threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit) and non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti).
- Bhatta: knownness (jñātatā) and contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti).
- Nyaya: anuvyavasaya and anyatha-khyati.
- Non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) means non-discrimination, not no cognition.
- Trap: error theory and validity theory answer different questions.

RAPID REVISION 5 - Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics

Rapid recall

- Bhatta: designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda).
- Prabhakara: connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhānavāda).
- Mimamsa usually prioritizes jati.
- Hermeneutic cues: sruti, linga, vakya, prakarana, sthana, samakhya.
- Trap: Vedic meaning cannot depend on a remembered human speaker.

RAPID REVISION 6 - Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa)

Rapid recall

- Veda is apauruṣeya and eternal in the relevant sense.
- Word-meaning relation is treated as natural.
- Creator and fruit-dispenser God are unnecessary.
- Self is enduring knower, agent and enjoyer.
- Trap: later liberation (mokṣa) is not merger with Brahman.

RAPID REVISION 7 - Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context

Rapid recall

- Strongest achievement: knowledge and language grounding impersonal duty.
- Main costs: eternal words, unseen ritual potency (apūrva), absence ontology and special means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas).
- CSU 2026-27 is educational context only.
- Best verdict: internally coherent, externally dependent on contested semantic and ritual assumptions.

RAPID REVISION 8 - PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

Rapid recall - master route

Prompt	Recall spine
Vedic duty (dharma)	injunction -> action -> unseen ritual potency (apūrva) -> fruit
Validity	intrinsic authority, extrinsic defeat
Postulation (arthāpatti)	explanatory incompatibility
Absence	yogyata and Bhatta non-cognition (anupalabdhi)
Awareness	triputi vs knownness (jñātātā) vs anuvyavasaya
Error	non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) vs contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)
Semantics	abhihitānvaya vs anvitābhīdhana
Veda	authorless authority without creator God

Original MCQ Bank - 32 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
1	Mīmāṃsā begins with: A. inquiry into Vedic duty (dharma) B. proof of God C. denial of self D. mystical union	A	The school starts from dharma-jijñāsā, not from speculative theology.
2	In the Mimamsa context, injunction (codanā) means: A. memory of duty B. impelling Vedic injunction C. comparison-based cognition D. prior non-existence	B	Injunction (codanā) is the command-form that makes duty action-guiding.
3	Which school accepts six means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)? A. Nyāya B. Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā C. Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā D. Sāṃkhya	C	Bhāṭṭa adds non-cognition (anupalabdhi) to the five accepted by Prābhākara.
4	Memory is denied pramāṇa-status chiefly because it: A. is always false B. depends on God C. lacks semantic fitness D. does not disclose a previously unknown object	D	Novelty is the decisive criterion.
5	Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) says that cognition is: A. prima facie valid by its own occurrence B. permanently infallible C. created by language D. valid only after success	A	Intrinsic validity means default trust, not incorrigibility.
6	Externally established invalidity (parataḥ-aprāmāṇya) means that invalidity is known through: A. intuition alone B. later contradiction or discovery of defect C. universals only D. deep sleep	B	Falsity is externally disclosed.
7	The stout Devadatta case is the classical example of: A. non-cognition (anupalabdhi) B. anuvyavasāya C. postulation (arthāpatti) D. sphoṭa	C	The conclusion is compelled explanatory postulation.
8	Nyāya's reduction of postulation (arthāpatti) relies most on a prior: A. obligation (niyoga) B. unseen ritual potency (apūrva) C. non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) D. invariable concomitance (vyāpti)	D	It tries to convert the case into standard inference.
9	Eligible non-cognition (yogyānupalabdhi) requires that the absent object: A. would be perceivable if present B. be eternal C. be remembered from childhood D. be scripturally revealed	A	Non-perception counts only when perception should have occurred.
10	According to Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā, absence (abhāva) is: A. mere grammar B. a real negative content known by non-cognition (anupalabdhi) C. impossible to cognize D. always inferential only	B	Bhāṭṭa grants both objecthood and a separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).
11	Threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit) means simultaneous manifestation of: A. three Vedas B. word, meaning and sentence C. knower, known and cognition D. duty, fruit and God	C	This is the Prābhākara answer to metacognition.
12	Knownness (jñātātā) refers to the object's: A. falsity B. universality C. ritual purity D. cognizedness, from which cognition is inferred	D	Kumārila denies self-luminosity of cognition and infers it from knownness (jñātātā).
13	Non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) explains illusion as: A. non-discrimination between perception and memory B. divine deception C. pure non-being D. only linguistic confusion	A	Prābhākara keeps the constituent cognitions valid.
14	Contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti) holds that illusion involves: A. only recollection B. a positive misapprehension under defect C. no cognition at all D. mere verbal error	B	Bhāṭṭa allows a false cognition without abandoning intrinsic validity.
15	Designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda) states that: A. words mean only particulars B. Veda has a divine author C. words first denote separate meanings and then get connected D. sentences alone are primary	C	This is the Bhāṭṭa theory of sentence meaning.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
16	Connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhanāvāda) states that words convey: A. only remembered objects B. abstract sounds without meaning C. bare universals alone D. meanings as already connected in sentential use	D	This is the Prābhākara contextualist position.
17	Ākāṅkṣā in sentence theory means: A. mutual expectancy among words B. speaker's private intention C. absence-cognition D. non-verbal meditation	A	Without expectancy, sentence unity does not arise.
18	Mīmāṃsā generally gives semantic priority to: A. silence B. universals (jāti) C. divine intention D. impossible objects	B	Repeatable application of a word is explained through jāti.
19	Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva) primarily protects the Veda from: A. ritual complexity B. historical transmission C. authorial defect D. sentence-unity	C	No human or divine author means no author-based error.
20	The strongest Mimamsa reason to reject a creator-God is that God would: A. abolish perception B. destroy universals C. remove duty D. become redundant beside action and moral consequence (karma) and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) or introduce partiality	D	This is the classic anti-theistic pressure point.
21	Śābdī impelling force (bhāvanā) is the: A. linguistic impelling force of the injunction B. bare-locus cognition of absence C. theory of memory D. post-mokṣa bliss	A	It explains how the Vedic word moves the agent to act.
22	Ārthī impelling force (bhāvanā) is the: A. eternity of words B. real productive force of the performed act C. relation between universal and particular D. later reflective cognition	B	It explains how action brings about the result.
23	Prābhākara's niyoga-vāda emphasizes: A. phala as the sole motive B. God's command C. the act as directly binding and to-be-done D. memory as duty	C	Duty arises from injunction itself, not merely from desired fruit.
24	Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) is best described as: A. a visible ritual fire B. a universal C. God in hidden form D. an unseen potency linking act and later fruit	D	It explains delayed ritual efficacy without theism.
25	Ritual deities in classical Mimamsa are primarily: A. mantra-denoted participants within sacrificial procedure B. creators of the world C. deniers of Veda D. equivalent to Brahman	A	They are not the sovereign dispensers of fruit.
26	Vedānta challenges Mimamsa by insisting that some Vedic sentences reveal: A. only ritual accessories B. an already accomplished reality (siddha-vastu) C. bare universals without context D. only social law	B	This marks the break between Pūrva- and Uttara-Mīmāṃsā.
27	The self in Mimamsa must be: A. momentary B. identical with language C. enduring as knower, agent and enjoyer D. unreal like illusion	C	Without continuity, action and moral consequence (karma) and ritual fruit collapse.
28	Later Mimamsa liberation (mokṣa) is best stated as: A. union with Lord (Īśvara) B. absorption into language C. public ritual prestige D. cessation of suffering and embodiment, not Brahman-identity	D	The doctrine is largely negative and should not be Vedāntized.
29	The statement "intrinsic validity means every cognition is permanently true" is: A. false because Mimamsa allows later defeat B. true because default trust is infallible C. true only for memory D. true only for error	A	The standard trap is to confuse default validity with final indefeasibility.
30	Nyāya explains awareness of cognition through: A. unseen ritual potency (apūrva) B. anuvyavāsāya C. injunction (codanā) D. non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti)	B	A higher-order cognition reflects on the first act of knowing.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
31	In ritual hermeneutics, vākya chiefly concerns: A. the historical author B. similarity with another ritual C. sentence-unity and connected textual meaning D. deep sleep	C	Vākya is one of the ranked interpretive clues.
32	The safest one-line summary of the topic is: A. theology in search of omniscience B. skepticism about all knowledge C. mysticism without duty D. knowledge in the service of Vedic duty (dharma)	D	That formula keeps epistemology tied to language, duty and ritual action.

Rotation audit: A -> B -> C -> D repeated eight times.

Remedial Error-Correction Drills

Drill	Common wrong move	Corrective repair	Why the correction matters
1	"Intrinsic validity means no cognition can ever be false."	Say: every cognition is prima facie valid, but later defeat can reveal falsity.	This prevents infallibilist misreading.
2	"Prābhākara accepts six means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) like Bhāṭṭa."	Say: Prābhākara accepts five ; Bhāṭṭa alone adds non-cognition (anupalabdhi) .	This is one of the most repeated factual traps.
3	"Postulation (arthāpatti) is just a fancy name for guesswork."	Say: it is compelled postulation produced by otherwise unresolved incompatibility.	The exam asks for its irreducible logic, not its superficial plausibility.
4	"Non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) means there is no cognition at all in illusion."	Say: there are valid cognitions, but their difference is not discriminated .	Without this, Prābhākara's theory collapses into absurdity.
5	"Bhāṭṭa accepts self-luminous cognition."	Say: Bhāṭṭa defends intrinsic validity but knows cognition through knownness (jñātātā) .	This is the decisive distinction between manifestation and validity.
6	"Mīmāṃsā proves Veda by invoking God."	Say: it secures the Veda by excluding divine authorship and defending Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva).	This preserves the school's distinctive orthodoxy-without-theism.
7	"Obligation (niyoga) and desire for fruit mean the same thing."	Say: Prābhākara makes obligation categorical, while Bhāṭṭa allows a stronger place for phala-motivation.	This prevents flattening the Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara ethical divide.
8	"Liberation (mokṣa) in Mimamsa is merger into Brahman."	Say: later Mimamsa generally presents liberation (mokṣa) negatively, as release from pain and embodiment.	This blocks Vedāntic importation into a ritual-epistemic school.

ADVANCED CLOSE-DISTINCTION MCQS - 16 QUESTIONS

Supplemental MCQ 1

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva) blocks defects of a human author; it is not a claim that sentences have no meaning. B. It makes the Veda a creation of Lord (Īśvara). C. It reduces Vedic authority to remembered custom. D. It requires Grammarian sentence-sphoṭa.

Answer: A. Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva) blocks defects of a human author; it is not a claim that sentences have no meaning.

Explanation: Mīmāṃsā grounds authority in beginningless word-meaning relations and absence of authorial defect.

Supplemental MCQ 2 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva) blocks defects of a human author; it is not a claim that sentences have no meaning.

2. It makes the Veda a creation of Lord (Īśvara).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. 1 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. Mīmāṃsā grounds authority in beginningless word-meaning relations and absence of authorial defect.

Supplemental MCQ 3

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Vedic duty (dharma) is identical with pleasure. B. Vedic duty (dharma) is inferred only from visible effects. C. Vedic duty (dharma) is primarily known through Vedic injunction (codanā), not ordinary perception. D. Vedic duty (dharma) is whatever a reliable human speaker commands.

Answer: C. Vedic duty (dharma) is primarily known through Vedic injunction (codanā), not ordinary perception.

Explanation: The school treats injunction as the distinctive disclosure of otherwise imperceptible duty.

Supplemental MCQ 4 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Vedic duty (dharma) is primarily known through Vedic injunction (codanā), not ordinary perception.
2. Vedic duty (dharma) is identical with pleasure.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. Both 1 and 2 C. Neither 1 nor 2 D. 1 only

Answer: D. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. The school treats injunction as the distinctive disclosure of otherwise imperceptible duty.

Supplemental MCQ 5

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) mediates between completed action and a temporally remote result. B. It is a creator deity. C. It is the sound-universal of a word. D. It is identical with perceptual contact.

Answer: A. Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) mediates between completed action and a temporally remote result.

Explanation: Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) explains deferred efficacy without requiring divine distribution.

Supplemental MCQ 6 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) mediates between completed action and a temporally remote result.
2. It is a creator deity.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. 1 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) explains deferred efficacy without requiring divine distribution.

Supplemental MCQ 7

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Both theories are Grammarian sphaṭa-vāda. B. Prabhākara denies sentence meaning. C. Kumārila's word-first theory (abhihitānvaya) joins already denoted word-meanings; Prabhākara's connected-designation theory

(anvitābhidhāna) takes words to signify only as connected. D. Kumārila says words never denote anything independently.

Answer: C. Kumārila's word-first theory (abhihitānvaya) joins already denoted word-meanings; Prabhākara's connected-designation theory (anvitābhidhāna) takes words to signify only as connected.

Explanation: The dispute concerns the route from words to sentential meaning.

Supplemental MCQ 8 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Kumārila's word-first theory (abhihitānvaya) joins already denoted word-meanings; Prabhākara's connected-designation theory (anvitābhidhāna) takes words to signify only as connected.
2. Both theories are Grammarian sphoṭa-vāda.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. Both 1 and 2 C. Neither 1 nor 2 D. 1 only

Answer: D. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. The dispute concerns the route from words to sentential meaning.

Supplemental MCQ 9

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) means cognition presents itself as valid unless defeated; falsity is established extrinsically. B. Every cognition remains true after decisive defeat. C. Validity requires a second cognition in every case. D. Memory is therefore always a fresh valid cognition.

Answer: A. Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) means cognition presents itself as valid unless defeated; falsity is established extrinsically.

Explanation: Default entitlement is defeasible, not infallibility.

Supplemental MCQ 10 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) means cognition presents itself as valid unless defeated; falsity is established extrinsically.
2. Every cognition remains true after decisive defeat.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. 1 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. Default entitlement is defeasible, not infallibility.

Supplemental MCQ 11

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Both reduce it to divine testimony. B. Prabhākara alone accepts it independently. C. Kumārila accepts non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as an independent means for knowing absence; Prabhākara does not add it as a separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). D. Neither school discusses absence cognition.

Answer: C. Kumārila accepts non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as an independent means for knowing absence; Prabhākara does not add it as a separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

Explanation: This is a standard Bhāṭṭa-Prabhākara distinction.

Supplemental MCQ 12 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Kumāṛila accepts non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as an independent means for knowing absence; Prabhākara does not add it as a separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).
2. Both reduce it to divine testimony.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. Both 1 and 2 C. Neither 1 nor 2 D. 1 only

Answer: D. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. This is a standard Bhāṭṭa-Prabhākara distinction.

Supplemental MCQ 13

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Kumāṛila explains error through misapprehension (viparīta-khyāti); Prabhākara through non-apprehension of difference (akhyāti). B. Both accept Nyāya's misplacement theory without alteration. C. Both hold the illusory object wholly unreal. D. Prabhākara explains error by sentence-sphoṭa.

Answer: A. Kumāṛila explains error through misapprehension (viparīta-khyāti); Prabhākara through non-apprehension of difference (akhyāti).

Explanation: Their error theories follow different analyses of presentation, memory and discrimination.

Supplemental MCQ 14 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Kumāṛila explains error through misapprehension (viparīta-khyāti); Prabhākara through non-apprehension of difference (akhyāti).
2. Both accept Nyāya's misplacement theory without alteration.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. 1 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. Their error theories follow different analyses of presentation, memory and discrimination.

Supplemental MCQ 15

Which one of the following is the most accurate statement?

A. Sphoṭa is Kumāṛila's name for unseen ritual potency (apūrva). B. Prabhākara makes sphoṭa the only means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). C. Sentence-sphoṭa belongs to the Grammarian comparison; Mīmāṃsā normally explains comprehension through words, wordhood and sentence-conditions. D. Mīmāṃsā attributes sphoṭa to Jaimini as ritual potency.

Answer: C. Sentence-sphoṭa belongs to the Grammarian comparison; Mīmāṃsā normally explains comprehension through words, wordhood and sentence-conditions.

Explanation: Mentioning sphoṭa requires an explicit attribution firewall.

Supplemental MCQ 16 - statement combination

Consider the following statements:

1. Sentence-sphoṭa belongs to the Grammarian comparison; Mīmāṃsā normally explains comprehension through words, wordhood and sentence-conditions.
2. Sphoṭa is Kumāṛila's name for unseen ritual potency (apūrva).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

A. 2 only B. Both 1 and 2 C. Neither 1 nor 2 D. 1 only

Answer: D. 1 only

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct; statement 2 confuses a nearby doctrine. Mentioning spṛṣṭa requires an explicit attribution firewall.

REVIEW-PROMOTED KNOWLEDGE-SOURCE AND HERMENEUTIC MCQS

49. Which account correctly states comparison in standard later Mīmāṃsā?

A. Perceiving a present gavaya as cow-like produces the new cognition that the remembered absent cow is similar to this gavaya. B. Hearing “a gavaya resembles a cow” directly fixes every future individual as gavaya. C. Similarity is inferred from a universal rule connecting every cow and gavaya. D. Comparison is only another name for verbal testimony.

Answer: A. Perceiving a present gavaya as cow-like produces the new cognition that the remembered absent cow is similar to this gavaya.

Explanation: The word-reference mechanism in option B is Nyāya's account. Mīmāṃsā makes the fresh cognition concern the absent familiar object's similarity to the presently perceived object.

50. Which sequence correctly describes Mīmāṃsā perception?

A. Determinate awareness first, followed by an objectless state. B. Indeterminate non-verbal awareness first, followed by determinate qualified cognition. C. Inference first, followed by sense-contact. D. Testimony first, followed by denial of the external object.

Answer: B. Indeterminate non-verbal awareness first, followed by determinate qualified cognition.

Explanation: Determinate perception articulates class, quality, action and name without making the original sensible object unreal.

51. Which pairing is correct?

A. Perceptual postulation-completion of a heard ellipsis; verbal postulation-stout Devadatta. B. Both types are ordinary inference from an independently known universal. C. Perceptual postulation-reconciliation of perceived facts; verbal postulation-supplementation required by heard words. D. Both types are tentative hypotheses with no claim of necessity.

Answer: C. Perceptual postulation-reconciliation of perceived facts; verbal postulation-supplementation required by heard words.

Explanation: The distinction concerns the source of the explanatory tension, while both remain necessary postulation.

52. Which list gives the standard answer-worthy functions of Vedic sentences?

A. Substance, quality, action, universal and inherence. B. Perception, inference, comparison, testimony and memory. C. Creation, preservation, destruction, concealment and grace. D. Injunction, prohibition, mantra, name and explanatory or praise passage.

Answer: D. Injunction, prohibition, mantra, name and explanatory or praise passage.

Explanation: Non-injunctive passages retain significance through their role in identifying, assisting or supporting action-guiding text.

53. Which statement best describes the Mīmāṃsā self and liberation?

A. Many enduring selves ground agency and fruit; later liberation ends fresh karmic production, embodiment and painful experience. B. One Brahman alone acts ritually through illusory selves. C. A momentary cognition-stream receives another stream's ritual fruit. D. Liberation is permanent sensory heaven produced directly by a creator.

Answer: A. Many enduring selves ground agency and fruit; later liberation ends fresh karmic production, embodiment and painful experience.

Explanation: Mīmāṃsā preserves personal continuity without importing Advaita identity or a Nyāya creator-fruit-dispenser.

54. How does Mīmāṃsā answer Buddhist meaning through exclusion?

A. By denying that words can apply repeatedly. B. By arguing that stable positive recognition requires a real shared class-character, not exclusion alone. C. By treating every universal as a creator God's idea. D. By reducing every word to a private memory-image.

Answer: B. By arguing that stable positive recognition requires a real shared class-character, not exclusion alone.

Explanation: The dispute is between universal realism and the Buddhist attempt to explain word-meaning through exclusion of non-members.

55. Which lineage and ownership statement is accurate?

A. Prabhākara wrote the Mīmāṃsā Sūtra and Jaimini founded Advaita. B. Śābara founded Nyāya and Kumārila accepted only perception. C. Jaimini supplies the sūtra-frame, Śābara the base commentary, and Kumārila and Prabhākara develop rival Mīmāṃsā lines. D. Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā and Vedānta have identical primary textual purposes.

Answer: C. Jaimini supplies the sūtra-frame, Śābara the base commentary, and Kumārila and Prabhākara develop rival Mīmāṃsā lines.

Explanation: Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā owns duty and ritual hermeneutics; Vedānta owns Brahman-centred Upaniṣadic interpretation.

56. Which distinction about testimony is correct?

A. All testimony is divine speech. B. Impersonal testimony depends on a remembered human author. C. Personal testimony cannot state ordinary facts. D. Personal testimony depends on a competent speaker; impersonal Vedic testimony does not depend on an author and can enjoin supersensible duty.

Answer: D. Personal testimony depends on a competent speaker; impersonal Vedic testimony does not depend on an author and can enjoin supersensible duty.

Explanation: Mīmāṃsā distinguishes speaker-dependent ordinary testimony from authorless Vedic testimony and also distinguishes fact-stating from action-enjoining sentences.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

EXAM APPLICATION 1 - The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma)

Exam route

- Open broad answers with **dharma-jijnasa through Vedic injunction**.
- Connect injunction (codanā) -> impelling force (bhāvanā)/obligation (niyoga) -> action -> unseen ritual potency (apūrva) -> fruit.
- Distinguish Bhatta result-oriented ritual psychology from Prabhākara's stronger duty emphasis.
- Do not present Mimamsa as ritualism with unrelated epistemology; show the structural connection.

EXAM APPLICATION 2 - Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture

Exam route

- **2018 Q8(a):** separate self-manifestation from validity and compare Nyaya, both Mimamsa lines and Advaita.
- **2020 Q5(c), 2024 Q8(c):** memory may be true but is not a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) because it lacks novelty.
- **2025 Q5(c):** compare intrinsic and extrinsic validity by origin, ascertainment, regress and correction.
- State both: intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) and externally established invalidity (parataḥ-apramāṇya).

EXAM APPLICATION 3 - Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence

Exam route

- **2022 Q6(c)**: state Nyaya's inferential reduction fairly, then give incompatibility, missing invariable concomitance (vyāpti) and structural objections.
- **2024 Q8(b)**: apply the candidate-success example without turning postulation (arthāpatti) into loose speculation.
- **2021 Q6(c), 2023 Q6(b), 2025 Q6(c)**: define absence (abhāva), yogyata and the Bhatta-Prabhakara divide.
- Always state what would be perceived if present.

EXAM APPLICATION 4 - Self-Awareness and Error: Tripuṭi, Knownness (jñātātā) and Two Mimamsa Theories

Exam route

- **2022 Q7(a)**: explain why shared intrinsic validity permits divergent error theories.
- **2024 Q8(a)**: compare threefold awareness (tripuṭi-saṃvit), knownness (jñātātā) and Nyaya anuvyavasaya.
- Use shell-silver for both error accounts, but do not confuse Bhatta contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti) with Nyaya anyatha-khyati.
- The Bhatta view proves intrinsic validity need not entail self-luminous cognition.

EXAM APPLICATION 5 - Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics

Exam route

- **2023 Q8(c)**: compare universal-first Mimamsa with qualified-individual-first Nyaya.
- **2024 Q5(d)**: distinguish abhīhitanvaya from anvītabhidhana through lexical priority and sentence unity.
- Include akankṣa, yogyata and sannidhi.
- Do not collapse sentence-composition theory into the universal-particular reference debate.

EXAM APPLICATION 6 - Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa)

Exam route

- **2019 Q5(e)**: establish Vedic authority through authorlessness, word-eternity and unique access to Vedic duty (dharma).
- Compare Mimamsa exclusion of author with Nyaya's omniscient author.
- For anti-theism, explain both redundancy and partiality dilemmas.
- Qualify liberation (mokṣa) historically: early stress on Vedic duty (dharma) and heaven, later negative liberation.

EXAM APPLICATION 7 - Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context

Exam route

Use a four-column structure: **objection -> Mimamsa reply -> gain -> residual pressure.**

High-risk checks:

1. Prabhakara has five means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas).
2. Intrinsic validity is defeasible.
3. Non-cognition (anupalabdhi) belongs independently to Bhatta.
4. Mimamsa secures Veda without God.
5. Unseen ritual potency (apūrvā) is neither fate nor God in disguise.

EXAM APPLICATION 8 - PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

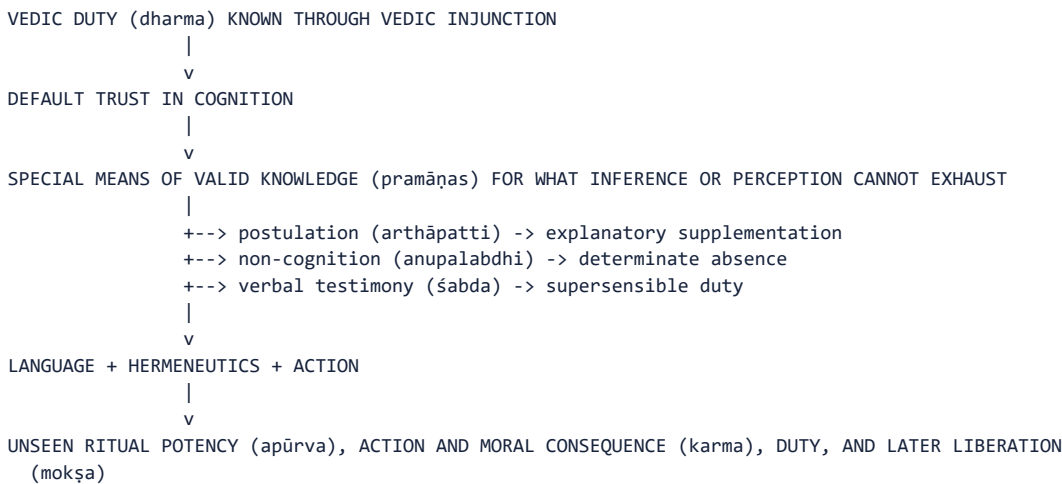
Exam route

The complete practice section contains:

- **14 verified solved PYQs** from 2018-2025.
- **32 original MCQs** with strict A-B-C-D rotation.
- Remedial error-correction drills.
- Original 10-, 15- and 20-mark questions with model solutions.
- Final consolidated register notes after all teaching and practice.

Learning Design and Retrieval Map

This package follows the doctrinal chain that actually organizes the topic:



Master distinction: Mīmāṃsā is strongest when read as a theory of **knowledge in the service of duty**. If you separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) theory from injunction, Vedic authority, language and unseen ritual potency (apūrva), the system starts looking like a disconnected list of doctrines.

Visual - Hermeneutic Knowledge Map

The same map should be mentally reused in answers: validity -> means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) -> language -> injunction -> unseen ritual potency (apūrva) -> criticism.

Rapid Retrieval Matrix

Prompt	One-line recall spine
Orientation	inquiry into Vedic duty (dharma) through Vedic injunction
Validity	intrinsic validity, extrinsic invalidity
Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)	5 Prābhākara / 6 Bhāṭṭa
Memory	not means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) because no novelty
Postulation (arthāpatti)	explanatory compulsion, Devadatta case
Non-cognition (anupalabdhi)	non-perception of what would be perceived if present
Self-awareness	threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit) vs knownness (jñātātā) vs anuvyavasāya
Error	non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) vs contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)
Semantics	abhihitānvaya vs anvitābhidhāna

Prompt	One-line recall spine
Veda	apauruṣeya, eternal, self-valid for Vedic duty (dharma)
Anti-theism	action and moral consequence (karma) and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) make creator-God redundant
Liberation (mokṣa)	later negative release, not Brahman-identity

SOLVED PYQ WORKBOOK - ALL 14 VERIFIED QUESTIONS

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q8(a), 20 marks

Question: Does the admission of Svayaṃprakāśavāda necessarily lead to the admission of Svataḥprāmāṇyavāda? Discuss after the Naiyāyikas, the Mīmāṃsakas and the Advaita Vedāntins.

Model solution

The relation is close but **not logically necessary**. **Svayaṃprakāśavāda** concerns how cognition or consciousness becomes manifest; **svataḥ-prāmāṇyavāda** concerns whether cognition carries its own prima facie validity. Manifestation and validity therefore address two different questions.

The **Naiyāyikas** deny both theses. A cognition is known through a later **anuvyavasāya**, and its validity is established extrinsically through correspondence, successful action or later confirmation. For Nyāya, immediate appearance does not yet amount to certified truth.

Among the **Mīmāṃsakas**, the issue divides sharply. **Prābhākara** supports a strong form of self-revelation through **threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit)**: knower, known and knowledge appear together. He also supports intrinsic validity, because another validating cognition would generate regress. Here self-luminosity and intrinsic validity travel together.

But **Kumārila Bhaṭṭa** breaks any claim of necessity. He too accepts intrinsic validity: cognition is trusted unless defeated by later contradiction or defect-awareness. Yet he denies that cognition is self-luminous. Cognition is known through the object's **knownness (jñātātā)** or cognizedness. Thus one may defend intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya) without accepting svayaṃprakāśa.

Advaita Vedānta complicates the issue further. Advaita strongly affirms self-luminous consciousness, but its final subject is not merely episodic cognition; it is consciousness as such, ultimately ātman-Brahman. Empirical cognitions function as valid until sublated, but Advaita's deepest self-luminosity thesis is metaphysical rather than merely epistemic. Hence the inference from self-revelation to intrinsic validity still requires argument.

School	Self-luminosity?	Intrinsic validity?	Result
Nyāya	No	No	both denied
Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	Yes	Yes	close linkage
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	No	Yes	decisive counterexample to necessity
Advaita	Yes, at the level of consciousness itself	broad presumption of validity until sublation	related, but not a simple entailment

Conclusion: self-luminosity may support intrinsic validity, but it does not necessarily entail it. The Bhāṭṭa position proves that a thinker may deny self-luminosity and still defend intrinsic validity; therefore the two doctrines must be kept conceptually distinct.

Why this earns marks: It separates manifestation from validity, compares all three requested schools, and uses the Bhāṭṭa position as the decisive argument against any claim of strict entailment.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q8(a), 20 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q5(e), 10 marks

Question: How does Mīmāṃsā establish the authority of Vedic knowledge?

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā establishes Vedic authority through **Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva)**, **eternity of word (śabda-nityatva)**, and the special domain of **Vedic duty (dharma)**. The Veda is authoritative because it is **authorless**, eternal and therefore free from the defects that affect personal testimony - ignorance, deception, forgetfulness or partiality. A human or divine author would introduce precisely the kind of locus of error that Mīmāṃsā wants to exclude.

The school also treats the relation between word and meaning as **autpattika**, natural or inherent, not a convention imposed by an institutor. Words are manifested in utterance rather than created anew. Hence the Veda does not depend for its authority on a historical act of composition.

Most importantly, the Veda has a unique object: **Vedic duty (dharma)**, which is supersensible. Perception and inference can tell us about ordinary worldly objects, but not about ritual duty and unseen fruit. Therefore Vedic testimony is indispensable in its own sphere. Testimony of a reliable person may also yield knowledge, but Vedic knowledge has a superior status because its object cannot be known otherwise.

Nyāya tries to secure scripture through God as an omniscient author. Mīmāṃsā rejects this as unnecessary and weaker: one would first have to prove God's existence, omniscience and sincerity. Authorlessness is thus the school's stronger route.

Why this earns marks: It states the three core supports - Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva), eternality and unique revelatory scope - and directly contrasts the Mimamsa strategy with Nyāya's God-author model.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q5(e), 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Why is memory not a valid knowledge according to Mīmāṃsā?

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā denies pramāṇa-status to memory because memory does **not** generate a previously unknown cognition. A valid means of knowledge must disclose an object with novelty and present epistemic force. Memory depends on an earlier cognition and a residual impression; it merely reproduces what has already been known.

This is why recollection is different from perception or inference. Perception reveals an object directly here and now. Inference yields a fresh mediate cognition. Memory, by contrast, only re-presents past content. It may be true, useful and practically important, but its truth is derivative from the original cognition on which it rests.

Both **Prābhākara** and **Nyāya** agree on this point. The dependence of memory on prior apprehension is exactly what disqualifies it from being a fresh source of valid knowledge.

Conclusion: memory is not false simply because it is memory; it is excluded because it lacks the novelty required of a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

Why this earns marks: It gives the exact exclusion criterion, distinguishes memory from fresh cognition, and avoids the trap of treating memory as false rather than merely non-pramāṇic.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q5(c), 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: What, according to Mīmāṃsakas, is the ontological status of absence (abhāva) and how does one know it? Explain and examine.

Model solution

For the **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas**, **absence (abhāva)** is real enough to be the object of determinate cognition. When I say, “there is no jar on the floor,” I am not merely ignorant of a jar; I positively know its absence. That cognition is structured by a **pratiyogin**, the counterpositive whose absence is at issue.

Bhāṭṭa therefore accepts **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). The classic formula is: absence is known through **non-apprehension of what would be apprehended if present**. This requires **eligible non-cognition (yogyānupalabdhi)** - fitness conditions such as proper light, functioning sense-organ, available locus and appropriate attention. Only then does non-perception disclose absence.

Prābhākara resists a separate non-cognition (anupalabdhi). He explains the case as perception of the bare locus unqualified by the absent object. **Nyāya** also rejects an independent non-cognition (anupalabdhi), though it accepts absence as ontologically significant and handles it through perception or inference.

View	Status of absence (abhāva)	How known?
Bhāṭṭa	real negative entity/content	non-cognition (anupalabdhi)
Prābhākara	not denied, but no new means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) required	bare-locus cognition
Nyāya	real category	perception or inference, not separate non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

Examination: Bhāṭṭa preserves the determinacy of negative cognition very well, but at the price of both a richer ontology and a new means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). Prābhākara is more economical, but critics ask whether “bare locus” really explains the judgment “the jar is absent.”

Verdict: the Bhāṭṭa account is stronger if one wants to preserve the full objecthood of absence; the Prābhākara account is stronger if one prioritizes ontological and epistemic economy.

Why this earns marks: It presents both the ontological and epistemic sides of the issue, gives the fitness condition for absence-knowledge, and ends with a balanced evaluative comparison.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 4 - 2021 Q6(c), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: How do Mīmāṃsakas refute the Nyāya view that Implication (arthāpatti) is reducible to Inference (anumāna) and establish Implication as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā treats **postulation (arthāpatti)** as a distinct means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) because it arises from **explanatory compulsion**, not from the sign-based structure of inference. The standard case is: “Devadatta is stout, and Devadatta does not eat during the day.” To preserve both accepted facts, one must postulate that Devadatta eats at night.

The Nyāya reduction attempts to turn this into inference:

- all stout persons who do not eat by day eat by night;
- Devadatta is stout and does not eat by day;
- therefore Devadatta eats by night.

Mīmāṃsā objects on three grounds. First, the alleged **invariable concomitance (vyāpti)** is not independently known; it is abstracted from the very explanatory tension that postulation (arthāpatti) is supposed to solve. Second, inference moves from **hetu** to **sādhya**, whereas postulation (arthāpatti) moves from **incompatible accepted facts** to a postulate that alone makes them coherent. Third, the postulation (arthāpatti) case lacks the normal **pakṣa-hetu-sādhya** structure.

Kumārila therefore insists that postulation (arthāpatti) is not a weak guess or provisional hypothesis. It yields the one fact without which the data remain untenable. Chatterjee and Datta put the point sharply: a hypothesis remains tentative, but postulation (arthāpatti) carries conviction as the only viable explanation.

Critical discussion: Nyāya can often reconstruct such cases inferentially, and that is why the debate survives. But the Mimamsa claim is that the inferential reconstruction is parasitic on a prior recognition of explanatory incompatibility. If that is right, postulation (arthāpatti) deserves independent status.

Verdict: postulation (arthāpatti) is best defended as the epistemic form of explanatory necessity; whether one grants it full independence depends on whether one thinks inferential reformulation captures or merely redescribes that necessity.

Why this earns marks: It states the Nyāya reduction fairly, gives the three standard Mimamsa objections, uses the Devadatta case correctly, and ends with a qualified critical verdict.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 5 - 2022 Q6(c), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2022 Q7(a), 20 marks

Question: In spite of accepting the intrinsic validity of knowledge, why and how Prabhākara and Kumārila differ in their interpretation of erroneous cognition? Discuss.

Model solution

Both Prabhākara and Kumārila accept **intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)**: cognition is prima facie valid and does not need prior external certification. Yet they diverge because they explain error in different ways.

For **Prabhākara**, the central issue is to preserve the truth of each constituent cognition. In shell-silver illusion, the present shining object is genuinely perceived as “this,” while previously seen silver is genuinely remembered. The error lies in **non-discrimination** between these two valid cognitions. This is **non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti)** or, more precisely, **vivekākhyāti** - failure to apprehend the difference. No single false cognition needs to be posited.

For **Kumārila**, this is too weak to explain the assertive force of illusion. The subject does not merely have a perception plus a memory; the subject really judges, “this is silver.” Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā therefore accepts a positive misapprehension, **contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)**. A false cognition occurs, but only under defective conditions - poor light, similarity, distance or other causal disturbance. Intrinsic validity is preserved because falsity is not basic; it is **extrinsically occasioned** and later disclosed through correction.

Issue	Prabhākara	Kumārila
Status of constituents	both perception and memory remain valid	a false synthetic cognition occurs
Name of theory	non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) / vivekākhyāti	contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)
Strategy for saving intrinsic validity	error lies in non-discrimination, not false cognition	normal cognition remains self-valid; error belongs to defective conditions
Strength	strong anti-skeptical economy	better explanation of the lived assertiveness of illusion
Weakness	seems too weak for “this is silver”	admits real falsity and must explain how default validity survives

Nyāya and Advaita help sharpen the point. Nyāya's **anyathākhyāti** relocates the real silver elsewhere; Advaita's **anirvacanīya-khyāti** treats the illusory object as neither real nor unreal. By contrast, both Mimamsa sub-schools remain broadly realist and anti-skeptical.

Conclusion: the disagreement does not cancel intrinsic validity. It shows two different ways of protecting it - Prabhākara by minimizing falsity, Kumārila by localizing falsity in defect-ridden conditions.

Why this earns marks: It explains why the paradox arises, reconstructs both theories through the shell-silver case, compares their strengths and weaknesses, and ties the whole debate back to intrinsic validity.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 6 - 2022 Q7(a), 20 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2023 Q6(b), 15 marks

Question: Present Bhaṭṭa's view of non-cognition (anupalabdhi) as a valid means of knowledge.

Model solution

Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā accepts **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** as an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) because determinate absence-cognition cannot, in its view, be reduced either to perception or to inference. When I judge, "the jar is not on the floor," I do not merely fail to see a jar; I positively know its absence.

The key formula is **eligible non-cognition (yogyānupalabdhi)**: non-apprehension of an object that **would** be apprehended if it were present. Four features matter - perceptibility of the object, availability of the locus, functioning sense-organ, and fit conditions such as light and attention. Under these conditions, non-perception becomes cognitively significant.

Bhāṭṭa denies reduction to perception because perception requires contact with a present object. Absence is not a positive sensible object in that way. He denies reduction to inference because the evidentiary force of not-seeing the jar already presupposes the principle that non-apprehension under fit conditions reveals absence; inferential reduction thus becomes circular.

Claim	Bhāṭṭa position
What is known?	a real absence with a counterpositive
How known?	by an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), non-cognition (anupalabdhi)
Limiting condition	only under yogyatā / fitness
Why not perception?	no present positive object is contacted
Why not inference?	inferential force already presupposes non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

Critical note: the theory preserves ordinary negative judgments very well, but it multiplies both ontology and means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas). This is why Prābhākara and Nyāya resist it.

Verdict: Bhaṭṭa's non-cognition (anupalabdhi) is strongest when one insists that absence-cognition is both determinate and irreducible.

Why this earns marks: It states the exact defining formula, explains the fitness condition, answers both reduction attempts, and ends with the standard critical qualification.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 7 - 2023 Q6(b), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2023 Q8(c), 15 marks

Question: Do words refer to universals or particulars or both? Present an exposition of Nyāya and Mīmāṃsā position with regard to above question along with suitable examples.

Model solution

The dispute is not over whether language can finally guide us to individuals; it is over **semantic priority**. **Mīmāṃsā** generally holds that words primarily denote **universals (jāti)**, while **Nyāya** gives priority to the **qualified individual (vyakti)**.

Mīmāṃsā argues that one and the same word - for example, "cow" - applies across many individual cows. This repeatability is best explained if the word first denotes **cow-ness**. In a concrete context, the universal becomes instantiated in this or that cow, and action then concerns the qualified individual. The school therefore preserves practical reference without surrendering universal meaning.

Nyāya reverses the order. A word refers to an individual that is qualified by universal, form and relational features. This better suits action-language. One milks or brings **this cow**, not a bare universal. The universal is not denied, but it is not the primary referent.

Issue	Mīmāṃsā	Nyāya
Primary denotation	jāti / universal	qualified individual
Main reason	explains repeatable use across many cases	explains concrete action and reference
What is not denied	contextual reach to individuals	role of universals in cognition

Example: in a Vedic sentence about sacrifice, Mīmāṃsā can say the word first conveys the class-character needed for repeatable rule-application; Nyāya insists that actual ritual performance requires a determinate qualified individual.

Conclusion: both schools can reach both universal and individual, but they differ on where semantic explanation should begin. Mīmāṃsā starts from repeatability; Nyāya starts from concrete qualified reference.

Why this earns marks: It gives both positions without caricature, explains the idea of semantic priority, and uses examples that connect ordinary language with ritual application.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 8 - 2023 Q8(c), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2024 Q5(d), 10 marks

Question: How does Bhaṭṭa's view of nature of word-meaning and sentential-meaning differ from Prabhākara's view? Critically discuss.

Model solution

The difference is captured by the two classic labels **designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda)** and **connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhānavāda)**.

For **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā**, words first denote their own separate meanings. Sentence-meaning arises later by connecting those already-denoted meanings. Hence the word is the primary semantic unit and the sentence is compositional.

For **Prābhākara**, words do not first present isolated meanings. They signify meanings only as **already connected** within a sentence. The sentence is primary, and isolated lexical meaning is an abstraction from living use.

Issue	Bhāṭṭa	Prābhākara
Theory name	designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda)	connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhānavāda)
First semantic unit	word	connected sentence-use
Strength	preserves stable lexical meaning	preserves contextual and action-guiding meaning
Main criticism	requires an additional connecting step	risks making isolated word-meaning too dependent on context

Both accept **ākāṅkṣā**, **yogyatā** and **sannidhi** as conditions of sentence-unity. The critical issue is whether sentence meaning is built from prior word-meanings or directly grasped as connected.

Verdict: Bhāṭṭa is stronger on compositional stability; Prābhākara is stronger on lived contextual comprehension.

Why this earns marks: It states both technical terms correctly, gives the difference in one clean table, and ends with a real critical contrast instead of mere paraphrase.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 9 - 2024 Q5(d), 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2024 Q8(a), 20 marks

Question: How do I know that I know? Answer this question with reference to the Naiyāyikas, the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Prābhākara.

Model solution

The problem is reflexive awareness: once an object is known, how is the **cognition itself** known? Nyāya, Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Prābhākara offer three distinct answers.

Prābhākara accepts **threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit)**. In every cognition, three things are simultaneously revealed: the knower, the known and the cognition. Awareness is self-manifest in the very act of presenting the object. This blocks regress: if cognition required another cognition to reveal it, an infinite chain would follow.

Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā denies that cognition is self-luminous. What becomes directly available is the object's **knownness (jñātatā)** or cognizedness - its being-known. From that state one infers that a cognition has occurred. Reflexive awareness is therefore mediated, not immediate.

Nyāya rejects both self-luminosity and jñātatā-inference as the final account. It explains metacognition through **anuvyavasāya**, a higher-order cognition that takes the first cognition as its object. I first know the pot, and then I have a second cognition of the form "I know the pot."

School	First-order cognition	How second-order awareness arises	Main advantage	Main difficulty
Prābhākara	object, self and cognition appear together	immediate self-revelation	anti-regress and phenomenological economy	critics say the triad is packed too tightly
Bhāṭṭa	object is known; cognition leaves cognizedness in the object	cognition inferred from knownness (jñātatā)	preserves object-realism and avoids self-luminous episodes	critics call knownness (jñātatā) an unnecessary extra entity
Nyāya	object is known in the first act	anuvyavasāya reflects on that act	clear distinction between object-knowledge and metacognition	critics say regress pressure is only postponed

A good comparison also shows what each school fears most. Prābhākara fears regress, Bhāṭṭa fears collapse into self-luminous idealism or unnecessary subjectivism, and Nyāya fears making every cognition self-certifying.

Conclusion: the three schools answer the same question by privileging different epistemic goods - immediacy, mediated realism and reflective structure. The sharpest Mimamsa insight is that cognition cannot be both necessary for all knowing and completely invisible to itself.

Why this earns marks: It covers all three requested schools in a structured comparison, uses the exact technical terms, and explains the philosophical motivation behind each account instead of merely naming them.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 10 - 2024 Q8(a), 20 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q8(b), 15 marks

Question: “A candidate who is never seen to be studying during the day time secures a high position in a competitive exam.” How would the Bhaṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas and the Naiyāyikas explain the success of this candidate? Discuss.

Model solution

The example is a modernized **postulation (arthāpatti)** case. The **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsaka** begins with two accepted facts: the candidate is never seen studying in the daytime, and yet secures a high rank. These facts are not jointly intelligible unless some unobserved preparation is postulated. Therefore the candidate must be studying at night, very early morning, or in another unobserved period. The knowledge is not inferential in the ordinary sense; it is a compelled explanatory postulation.

The **Naiyāyika** attempts to restate the case as an inference. Success in a competitive examination is regularly connected with adequate preparation. This candidate is successful. Therefore this candidate must have prepared. The unobserved preparation is established inferentially from a known relation between success and study.

School	Logical movement	Strength	Weakness
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	incompatible accepted facts -> necessary postulate	captures the “must be so” force of the case	critics say it can be re-described as inference
Nyāya	known relation -> inferential conclusion	keeps one unified theory of mediate knowledge	critics say the explanatory tension is being hidden inside the universal premise

Discussion: the Bhāṭṭa claims that the Naiyāyika universal is not independently available; it is extracted from the very explanatory need at issue. Nyāya replies that once the relation between success and preparation is allowed, inference is enough.

Verdict: the case is philosophically useful precisely because it sits at the boundary between postulation and inference; Bhāṭṭa says that boundary is real, Nyāya says it is reducible.

Why this earns marks: It recognizes the example as a modern postulation (arthāpatti) test-case, presents both explanations fairly, and explains why the dispute survives instead of giving a one-line winner.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q8(b), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q8(c), 15 marks

Question: On what grounds do the Prābhākaras and the Naiyāyikas reject memory as a source of knowledge? Discuss.

Model solution

Both Prābhākaras and Naiyāyikas reject memory as a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) because memory lacks the **novel presentational force** that belongs to genuine means of knowledge. It depends on a prior cognition and a residual mental trace.

For the **Prābhākaras**, a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) must produce fresh cognition of an object. Memory simply reproduces what has already been known. It does not disclose an object as presently given; rather, it recalls what was previously apprehended. Its dependence on earlier knowledge is therefore intrinsic to its non-pramāṇic character.

The **Naiyāyikas** reach a similar conclusion from a different angle. Valid cognition must arise from the proper operation of a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) such as perception, inference, comparison or testimony. Memory does not arise from present contact with an object, a current inferential mark, a live comparison or a fresh utterance. It arises from a **saṃskāra** left by earlier cognition. Therefore it may be true, but it is not knowledge newly generated by a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

Ground of rejection	Prābhākara emphasis	Nyāya emphasis
lack of novelty	decisive	decisive
dependence on prior cognition	explicit criterion	implicit through saṃskāra theory
present disclosure	absent	absent
truth-value	memory may be true	memory may be true

Conclusion: both schools reject memory not because it is false, but because it is derivative and non-originate. The shared criterion is novelty; the main difference lies in the wider epistemological systems in which that criterion is embedded.

Why this earns marks: It answers the exact “grounds” asked for, gives both schools separately, and avoids the common mistake of calling memory invalid simply because it looks backward.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q8(c), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Delineate the main points of difference between the theory of intrinsic validation (svataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) and theory of extrinsic validation (parataḥ prāmāṇyavāda) in classical Indian philosophy.

Model solution

The difference concerns both the **source** of validity and the **way** validity becomes known.

In **svataḥ-prāmāṇyavāda**, defended classically by Mīmāṃsā, cognition is valid by its own occurrence under normal conditions. It presents itself as trustworthy and is acted upon unless defeated by later contradiction or discovery of defect. Invalidity is therefore extrinsic and subsequent.

In **parataḥ-prāmāṇyavāda**, associated in the standard contrast with Nyāya, the mere occurrence of cognition does not suffice for its validation. Truth is secured through something outside the cognition itself - successful action, later confirming cognition, or reflective assessment.

Issue	Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)	External validation (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)
initial status	prima facie valid	not fully validated by bare occurrence
need for external certificate	no	yes
invalidity	discovered through later defect or contradiction	built into validation process through external checks
strongest Mimamsa argument	avoids infinite regress and matches practical life	Nyāya says this leaves cognition under-verified
strongest Nyāya concern	Mimamsa says it risks regress and hidden prior trust	avoids gullibility and demands verification

Conclusion: the first begins with trust and allows correction later; the second begins with the need for validation and risks regress unless it can explain how validating cognition itself becomes acceptable.

Why this earns marks: It delineates the doctrine on exactly the requested axis, uses the standard school contrast, and states the decisive strength of each side in one compact answer.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q5(c), 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2025 Q6(c), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the debate between the Bhāṭṭa and the Prabhākara mīmāṃsakas with reference to the nature of Non-existence (Abhāva) and its knowledge.

Model solution

The debate turns on two linked questions: **what is absence (abhāva)?** and **how is it known?**

The **Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsakas** hold that non-existence is a real negative content capable of cognition. If I know that the jar is absent from the floor, the absence is not merely a linguistic convenience; it is an object structured by the relation to its counterpositive, the jar. Since perception requires contact with a present object, and inference requires a sign, Bhāṭṭa treats absence-cognition as requiring a distinct means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa): **non-cognition (anupalabdhi)**.

The **Prabhākaras** refuse both the extra ontology and the extra means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). What is directly cognized is the locus itself, unqualified by the absent object. The floor is simply presented as jar-less. Hence there is no need to introduce a separate means of knowledge.

Issue	Bhāṭṭa	Prabhākara
nature of absence (abhāva)	real negative content	no denial of the judgment, but no independent negative entity is needed
knowledge of absence	non-cognition (anupalabdhi)	ordinary cognition of the bare locus
motivation	preserve the determinacy of negative cognition	preserve epistemic and ontological economy
main problem	multiplies means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) and objects	may not fully explain the determinacy of "absence of X"

The deepest disagreement is methodological. Bhāṭṭa is willing to posit new epistemic resources when experience demands them. Prabhākara is more austere and prefers to avoid multiplication unless reduction fails completely.

Verdict: Bhāṭṭa offers the fuller account of negative cognition; Prabhākara offers the leaner account. The choice depends on whether explanatory adequacy or economy is treated as philosophically decisive.

Why this earns marks: It centers the answer on the exact two-fold debate - nature and knowledge of absence (abhāva) - and concludes with the underlying methodological contrast between the two sub-schools.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Solved PYQ 14 - 2025 Q6(c), 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Original Mains Practice

Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how injunction (codanā), impelling force (bhāvanā) and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) together make Mīmāṃsā a theory of duty rather than a mere theory of knowledge.

Model solution

Injunction (codanā) makes Vedic language prescriptive: Vedic duty (dharma) is known as what the Veda enjoins. **Impelling force (bhāvanā)** explains how that injunction works. In Bhāṭṭa terms, **śābdī impelling force (bhāvanā)** impels the qualified agent to act, while **ārthī impelling force (bhāvanā)** belongs to the actual performance that produces the result. **Unseen ritual potency (apūrva)** then links the visible but perishing act to a later unseen fruit.

These three ideas therefore form one chain. Injunction (codanā) gives duty its linguistic form, impelling force (bhāvanā) gives injunction its motivational and productive structure, and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) secures delayed efficacy without requiring a creator-God. Without injunction (codanā), the Veda would become descriptive; without impelling force (bhāvanā), command would not generate action; without unseen ritual potency (apūrva), the

gap between act and fruit would remain unexplained.

A Vedāntin may object that this subordinates too much scriptural meaning to action. Mīmāṃsā accepts the price because its project is not metaphysical disclosure first, but the determination of Vedic duty (dharma).

Why this earns marks: It answers the directive through one integrated chain, uses the exact technical terms, and shows how language, action and unseen efficacy fit together.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Practice 1 - 10 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Practice 2 - 15 marks

Question: Is Prābhākara's threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit) a stronger account of self-awareness than Nyāya anuvyavasāya and Bhāṭṭa knownness (jñātātā)? Evaluate.

Model solution

Prābhākara's **threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit)** is powerful because it meets the regress objection most directly. If cognition were not somehow manifest in the very act of knowing, another cognition would be needed to reveal it, and that second cognition would need a third. By holding that knower, known and cognition are given together, Prābhākara preserves immediacy.

Against this, **Nyāya** offers **anuvyavasāya** - a second-order cognition of the form "I know the pot." Its strength is analytic clarity: it sharply separates object-knowledge from reflective awareness. Its weakness is that the regress worry does not fully disappear; one must explain why the higher-order cognition does not require a further one.

Bhāṭṭa avoids both full self-luminosity and explicit second-order reflection by appealing to **knownness (jñātātā)**. Cognition is inferred from the object's cognizedness. This preserves a stronger object-realism, but critics complain that knownness (jñātātā) looks like an extra entity introduced only to avoid self-manifest cognition.

Evaluation: threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit) is strongest if anti-regress economy is treated as decisive. Nyāya is strongest if reflective structure is prioritized. Bhāṭṭa is strongest if one wants reflexive awareness without granting self-luminous episodes. No single theory is cost-free.

Why this earns marks: It evaluates rather than merely lists, explains the different philosophical motivations, and gives a balanced verdict instead of a one-sided assertion.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Practice 2 - 15 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

Practice 3 - 20 marks

Question: Can Mīmāṃsā consistently defend an authorless Veda, deny God, and still claim objective normativity? Discuss.

Model solution

Mīmāṃsā answers this challenge by shifting the ground of normativity away from divine will and toward the objective authority of an **apauruṣeya** text. The Veda is authorless, eternal and free from the defects that plague personal testimony. Because Vedic duty (dharma) is supersensible, no ordinary means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) can independently generate it; Vedic injunction is therefore uniquely authoritative in its own domain.

Normativity enters through **injunction (codanā)** and **obligation (niyoga)** / **impelling force (bhāvanā)**. A Vedic sentence is not merely descriptive but action-guiding. Duty binds because the injunction itself presents an act as to-be-done for a qualified agent. This impersonal model removes dependence on a lawgiver. The later fruit of

obedience is explained by **unseen ritual potency (apūrva)**, the unseen potency produced by correct action. Thus Mīmāṃsā can deny a creator-God while still offering a structured account of obligation and efficacy.

The position is internally coherent, but not unproblematic. **Nyāya** objects that meaning and authority are easier to understand if grounded in an omniscient author. **Buddhist** critics deny eternal words and natural word-meaning relations. **Advaita** objects that not all Vedic meaning is injunctive, since Upaniṣadic statements reveal an accomplished reality. Further, critics may ask whether unseen ritual potency (apūrva) and authorless language are explanatory successes or theoretical devices designed to rescue ritualism.

Yet Mīmāṃsā has a real philosophical achievement: it shows that objective normativity need not be equated with divine command. A text can bind, on this model, because of its impersonal validity, stable semantic force and exclusive access to a supersensible domain.

Verdict: within its own realist and hermeneutic presuppositions, Mīmāṃsā can consistently defend objective normativity without God. Its deepest vulnerability lies not in inconsistency, but in the contested assumptions of eternal language and unseen efficacy.

Why this earns marks: It reconstructs the system's internal coherence, brings in rival objections, and ends with a graded verdict that distinguishes inconsistency from contestability.

How to improve this answer: Re-check the exact directive in *Practice 3 - 20 marks*, add one named canonical text or school-specific argument, state the strongest objection and reply, and end with a qualified verdict rather than a generic summary.

Exam-length execution: For 10/15/20 marks, compress this into roughly 150/250/250 words respectively: definition and thesis; two or three claim -> named evidence -> analysis units; one objection/reply; then a one-sentence qualified conclusion.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 - The Mimamsa Project: Knowledge in the Service of Vedic duty (dharma)

Advanced normativity without divine command

The school's unity lies in its governing problem. Vedic duty (dharma) cannot be perceived, while ordinary inference cannot independently establish ritual obligation. Vedic injunction therefore supplies normative knowledge, semantics explains sentence-unity, and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) explains delayed efficacy.

Bhatta *bhavana-vada* stresses linguistic impulsion, action and desired fruit; Prabhakara *niyoga-vada* gives greater priority to the binding character of the act as to-be-done. The difference resembles consequential and deontological emphasis only loosely because both remain grounded in impersonal Vedic authority.

Vedānta presses the deepest textual objection: some Vedic sentences reveal an accomplished reality rather than command action. Mimamsa resists detaching scriptural meaning from practical function, exposing the fault line between Purva and Uttara Mimamsa.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 - Intrinsic Validity and the Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) Architecture

Advanced regress and self-luminosity distinction

If every cognition needs another cognition to certify it, the validator itself needs certification and regress follows. Mimamsa therefore locates authority in the original cognition under normal conditions while locating falsity in later-discovered defect or contradiction.

Nyāya replies that successful action and correspondence provide external validation. Mimamsa counters that one must already trust cognition enough to initiate the validating action. The dispute concerns epistemic starting-point, not whether correction is possible.

Validity and manifestation must remain distinct. Prabhakara combines triputi self-manifestation with intrinsic validity, but Kumārila knows cognition through *knownness (jñātātā)* while still defending intrinsic validity. The Bhatta position decisively blocks any claim of logical entailment between self-luminosity and default authority.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 - Postulation (arthāpatti) and Non-cognition (anupalabdhi): Explanatory Necessity and Absence

Advanced reduction debates

Nyaya reconstructs postulation (arthāpatti) as inference, but Mimamsa argues that the alleged universal relation is extracted from the very explanatory tension that needs resolution. The cognition moves from incompatible accepted facts to a necessary supplement rather than from a known sign to a probandum.

Bhatta grants absence structured objecthood and an independent means of knowledge. *Eligible non-cognition (yogyānupalabdhi)* limits the claim: only an object perceptible under available conditions can be known absent through non-apprehension. This blocks arguments from failure to perceive intrinsically imperceptible entities.

Prabhakara explains the same case through cognition of the bare locus, while Nyaya accepts absence but resists a new means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). Bhatta best preserves determinate negative judgment; the rivals purchase greater economy.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 - Self-Awareness and Error: Tripuṭi, Knownness (jñātātā) and Two Mimamsa Theories

Advanced anti-regress and assertiveness problems

Threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit) directly blocks regress by making cognition manifest with knower and object. Nyaya gains analytic clarity through second-order awareness but must explain why reflection does not require endless reflection. Bhatta's *knownness (jñātātā)* preserves object-centred realism but may look like an extra posit.

Prabhakara's non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) protects the truth of each constituent: present "this" perception and remembered silver. Error is failure to discriminate. Its weakness is the assertive force of "this is silver." Bhatta's contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti) explains that force through a genuinely false synthesis caused by defects while retaining default validity under normal conditions.

The underlying methodological contrast is economy versus phenomenological adequacy: minimize false cognition or explain illusion as actually experienced.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 - Word Meaning, Sentence Meaning and Ritual Hermeneutics

Advanced semantics without a speaker

Mimamsa cannot ground Vedic sentence-unity primarily in an author's intention because the Veda is authorless. It therefore develops textual and semantic conditions that operate without psychological authorship.

The Bhatta theory secures stable lexical meaning but must explain the additional compositional act. Prabhakara captures contextual and action-guiding unity but risks making isolated word meaning difficult to explain.

The universal-particular debate is separate. Mimamsa generally gives semantic priority to universals to explain repeatable use; Nyaya starts from the qualified individual to explain concrete action. Both can reach both levels but disagree about explanatory priority.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 - Authorless Veda, Anti-Theism, Action and moral consequence (karma) and Later Liberation (mokṣa)

Advanced objective normativity without God

Vedic authorlessness (apauruṣeyatva), word-eternity and an inherent word-meaning relation secure Vedic testimony in its special domain of supersensible duty. The strategy is anti-sceptical but historically and linguistically demanding: conventionalists challenge eternal language and natural semantic relations.

The school remains orthodox because orthodoxy means Vedic fidelity, not creator-theism. Action and moral consequence (karma) and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) explain fruit; God either becomes redundant if he follows action and moral consequence (karma) or partial if he overrides it. Ritual deities remain procedure-bound rather than sovereign creators.

An enduring self is required to connect action and later experience. Later Mimamsa liberation (mokṣa) is largely cessation of pain, embodiment and karmic entanglement; it should not be transformed into Advaitic Brahman-identity.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 - Comparisons, Criticisms, Traps and the Contemporary Sanskrit Context

Advanced critical balance

Intrinsic validity avoids regress and explains ordinary epistemic confidence, but critics ask whether default authority merely postpones certification. Postulation (arthāpatti) captures explanatory compulsion, yet Nyaya can often simulate it inferentially. Non-cognition (anupalabdhī) preserves negative judgments at the cost of a new means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) and richer ontology.

Authorless language removes authorial defect but leaves the problem of how meaning and normativity arise without intention. Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) links act and fruit but can look like a theoretical placeholder replacing divine administration.

The official 2026-27 Central Sanskrit University programmes and Sanskrit-promotion schemes provide a legitimate educational linkage: they sustain shastra teaching, publication and interpretive training. They do not prove classical doctrines such as authorlessness or ritual efficacy.

OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 - PYQ Routing, Answer Architecture and Complete Exam Deployment

Advanced corpus strategy

Mīmamsa appears in every year from 2018 through 2025. The recurrence is structured rather than random: validity, memory, postulation (arthāpatti), absence, self-awareness, error, semantics and Vedic authority form reusable modules.

Master one example for each module-Devadatta, empty table, shell-silver, "cow", and Vedic injunction. Then attach the correct sub-school, rival reduction and residual difficulty.

The final register notes should be used after solving practice. They preserve the integrated chain from validity and language to duty and unseen ritual potency (apūrva) rather than replacing the arguments.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Orientation and textual base

- Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā = inquiry into **Vedic duty (dharma)**, not first into Brahman or God.
- Jaimini gives the sūtra-frame; Śābara grounds classical exegesis.
- Kumārila = Bhāṭṭa line; Prabhākara = Prābhākara line.
- Chatterjee-Datta formula: Mīmāṃsā serves ritualism by **method of interpretation + philosophical defense**.
- Fast identity line: **knowledge in the service of duty**.

Vedic duty (dharma), injunction (codanā) and ritual efficacy

- codana - laksano 'rtho dharmah = Vedic duty (dharma) is known through Vedic injunction.
- **Prescriptive injunction (vidhi)** enjoins; **niṣedha** prohibits.
- **Śābdī impelling force (bhāvanā)** impels the agent; **āthī impelling force (bhāvanā)** is productive activity.
- **Unseen ritual potency (apūrva)** links act and future fruit.
- **Obligation (niyoga)** = directly binding "to-be-done," especially in Prābhākara.
- **Aṃśa-traya** = what, by what means, and how.

Validity and means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)

- **Intrinsic validity (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)** = intrinsic validity; **externally established invalidity (parataḥ-aprāmāṇya)** = extrinsic invalidity.
- Belief is normal; disbelief is exceptional.
- Nyāya counter = external validation (parataḥ-prāmāṇya) through validation.
- Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas):
- Prābhākara = 5

- Bhāṭṭa = 6
- Memory is excluded because it lacks novelty, not because it is always false.

Postulation (arthāpatti) and non-cognition (anupalabdhi)

- **Postulation (arthāpatti)** = explanatory necessity, not guess.
- Standard example: stout Devadatta who does not eat by day -> must eat at night.
- **Non-cognition (anupalabdhi)** = non-perception of what would be perceived if present.
- **Yogyatā** is decisive.
- Bhāṭṭa grants absence (abhāva) real objecthood and a separate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa); Prābhākara chooses economy.

Self-awareness and error

Problem	Prābhākara	Bhāṭṭa	Nyāya
cognition of cognition	threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit)	jñātātā-inference	anuvyavasāya
illusion	non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti)	contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti)	anyathā-khyāti

- Non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) = non-discrimination between valid perception and valid memory.
- Contrary-cognition theory of error (viparīta-khyāti) = positive misapprehension under defect.
- Shell-silver is the standard test-case.

Word and sentence meaning

- Sentence-unity depends on **ākāṅkṣā**, **yogyatā**, **sannidhi**.
- **Designation-then-connection theory (abhihitānvayavāda)**: words first denote separately, then connect.
- **Connected-designation theory (anvitābhīdhānavāda)**: words denote already-connected meanings.
- Mīmāṃsā generally prioritizes **jāti**; Nyāya prioritizes qualified **vyakti**.
- Ritual hermeneutics: **śruti**, **liṅga**, **vākya**, **prakaraṇa**, **sthāna**, **samākhyā**, plus **utsarga-apavāda**.

Veda, God and normativity

- Veda = **apauruṣeya** and, in the relevant sense, eternal.
- Word-meaning relation = **autpattika**, not merely conventional.
- Mīmāṃsā rejects creator-God and fruit-dispenser God.
- Action and moral consequence (karma) + unseen ritual potency (apūrva) do the explanatory work.
- Ritual deities remain inside procedure, but are not sovereign dispensers of result.

Self, world, action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation (mokṣa)

- World is real.
- Self is enduring knower, agent and enjoyer.
- Ritual fruit presupposes continuity of self.
- Later liberation (mokṣa) = cessation of pain and embodiment; do not import Advaita's Brahman-identity.
- Early stress remains stronger on **Vedic duty (dharma)** and **svarga**.

Review-promoted taxonomy controls

- Textual spine: Jaimini's sūtra -> Śābara's commentary -> Kumārila's Bhāṭṭa and Prābhākara's Prābhākara lines.
- Perception: indeterminate perception (nirvikalpaka-pratyakṣa) -> determinate perception (savikalpaka-pratyakṣa).
- Mīmāṃsā comparison (upamāna): present gavaya resembles remembered absent cow; do not use Nyāya's word-reference definition.
- Testimony: personal testimony (pauruṣeya-śabda) versus impersonal testimony (apauruṣeya-śabda); fact-stating versus action-enjoining sentences.
- Postulation: perceptual postulation (dṛṣṭārthāpatti) versus verbal postulation (śrutārthāpatti).
- Vedic sentence functions: injunction, prohibition, mantra, name and explanatory/praise passage.

- Injunction types: novel, restrictive and exclusionary; keep these distinct from act, application, order and qualified-agent functions.
- Buddhist exclusion (apoha) denies real universals; Mīmāṃsā defends a positive shared class-character.
- Many enduring selves ground agency and fruit; later liberation ends fresh karmic production, embodiment and pain.

PYQ route map

- 2018: self-luminosity versus intrinsic validity.
- 2019: Vedic authority.
- 2020: memory not means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).
- 2021: absence (abhāva) and its knowledge.
- 2022: postulation (arthāpatti) vs inference; error within intrinsic validity.
- 2023: non-cognition (anupalabdhi); universals versus particulars.
- 2024: sentence meaning; metacognition; candidate-success case; memory again.
- 2025: intrinsic vs extrinsic validation; Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara absence debate.

Answer spines

10 marks: define -> standard example -> rival contrast -> one-line criticism -> direct verdict.

15 marks: frame the issue -> mechanism in steps -> example -> objection/reply -> qualified conclusion.

20 marks: conceptual distinction -> full reconstruction -> Bhāṭṭa/Prābhākara split -> Nyāya/Advaita comparison -> deepest criticism -> graded verdict.

Final traps

1. Prābhākara is **five-pramāṇa**, not six-pramāṇa.
2. Intrinsic validity is not infallibility.
3. Bhāṭṭa denies self-luminous cognition but keeps intrinsic validity.
4. Postulation (arthāpatti) is not mere guess.
5. Non-cognition (anupalabdhi) is Bhāṭṭa's distinct contribution.
6. Non-discrimination theory of error (akhyāti) is not no-cognition.
7. Mīmāṃsā does not need God to ground Veda.
8. Sentence meaning debate and universal-particular debate must not be collapsed.
9. Unseen ritual potency (apūrva) is not visible causation and not God-in-disguise.
10. Mimamsa optional answers score best when they keep **epistemology, language and duty** together.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/9: Textual lineage and Vedic duty

JAIMINI -> SABARA -> KUMARILA / PRABHAKARA
Purva-Mimamsa owns duty, injunction and ritual interpretation
Vedanta owns the Brahman-centred Upanisadic inquiry
Vedic duty (dharma) is known through injunction (codanā), not perception
prescriptive sentence -> impelling force (bhāvanā) -> ritual action
-> unseen ritual potency (apūrva) -> delayed result

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/9: Validity and knowledge sources

INTRINSIC VALIDITY (SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀṆYA)
cognition presents itself as true unless a later defeater establishes error
Bhatta accepts six sources; Prabhakara does not treat non-cognition independently
Nyaya contrast -> external validation (parataḥ-prāmāṇya)
regress pressure supports first-trust, but correction still requires defeat

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/9: Perception, comparison and testimony

INDETERMINATE PERCEPTION -> DETERMINATE PERCEPTION
comparison: present gavaya resembles remembered absent cow
Nyaya contrast: word-reference learning is not the Mimamsa definition
personal testimony depends on a speaker; Vedic testimony is impersonal
testimony may state a fact or enjoin an action

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/9: Postulation and non-cognition

POSTULATION (ARTHĀPATTI): EXPLANATORY FACT REQUIRED BY OTHERWISE CONFLICTING FACTS
Devadatta is stout + does not eat by day -> he eats at night
perceived-fact postulation differs from heard-sentence postulation
NON-COGNITION (ANUPALABDHI): KNOWLEDGE OF AN ELIGIBLE ABSENCE
empty floor is seen under conditions in which the pot would have been seen
trap: postulation is not loose guessing; non-cognition is not simple inattention

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/9: Self-awareness and error

PRABHAKARA: THREEFOLD AWARENESS (TRIPUṬĪ-SAMVIT)
one cognition discloses knower, known and knowing together
BHATTA: KNOWNNESS (JÑĀTATĀ) REVEALS THAT COGNITION OCCURRED
error -> non-discrimination theory versus contrary-cognition theory
both avoid an infinite second-cognition regress by different strategies

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/9: Word and sentence meaning

SENTENCE UNITY NEEDS EXPECTANCY + COMPATIBILITY + PROXIMITY
designation-then-connection: words first denote, then meanings combine
connected-designation: words directly present meanings already related
word universal realism answers Buddhist meaning-through-exclusion
Vedic functions: injunction, prohibition, mantra, name, explanatory praise
semantic theory protects action-guiding scripture without an original speaker

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/9: Vedic authorlessness and God

VEDIC AUTHORLESSNESS (APĀURUṢEYATVA) BLOCKS HUMAN ERROR AT THE SOURCE
eternity of word supports an uncreated relation between word and meaning
Nyaya grounds scripture in a trustworthy divine speaker; Mimamsa does not
God is unnecessary for Vedic authority, ritual efficacy or karmic distribution
pressure: removing an author secures autonomy but complicates semantic intention

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/9: Self, liberation and criticism

MANY ENDURING SELVES SUPPORT MEMORY, AGENCY, DESERT AND REBIRTH
cognition is episodic; self persists across body, senses and action
liberation = end of new merit/demerit, embodiment and painful experience
strength: sophisticated epistemology, semantics and non-theistic normativity
Buddhist and Carvaka objections target self, universals and non-perceptual claims

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/9: PYQ answer synthesis

IDENTIFY BHATTA / PRABHAKARA BEFORE WRITING
state doctrine -> give canonical example -> contrast Nyaya -> assess residual issue
link intrinsic validity to postulation, non-cognition and Vedic authority
use exact terminology only after the English concept
verdict: powerful theory of knowledge and duty, contested ritual metaphysics